Pseudopassives, Pied-Piping, and A-Movement of PPs

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Abstract: This paper documents and analyzes an interaction between the clausal A-syntax and the complement of P^0 in Mandar, a verb-initial ergative language of Central Indonesia. When complex PPs take the positions of absolutive DPs, this language allows a series of structural shifts that license interaction between their nominal complements and T^0, suppressing the source of PP-internal Case and forcing raising to the edge of the extended PP. From this position, it shows that the path up to T^0 runs through a pair of higher A-positions and requires an intermediate step of preposition-stranding at the edge of the extended VP: one which reveals that the A-syntax must have the capacity to attract and pied-pipe PPs. Drawing a link to the pseudopassive (Hornstein & Weinberg, 1981; Drummond & Kush, 2015), the paper then builds a theory of the conditions that license pied-piping of this type: one that leverages a parallel breakdown of locality to argue that the edge of the phase must license a second type of A-attraction that is exempt from the need to target the closest DP.

Keywords:

Pseudopassive, Pied-Piping, A-Movement; Prepositional Phrases; Sulawesi; Austronesian

1 Introduction

Since Postal 1971 and Chomsky 1977, the phrasal movements of the syntax have typically been divided into two internally coherent categories that are mutually opposed: A and Ā. The movements of the first class are those that ferry regular nominals through consistent positions along the clausal spine, interacting with the systems of Case and ϕ-agreement to deliver the derived structural prominence of subjects, objects, and other core aregruments. The movements of the second class, in turn, are those that draw a finer class of elements (which are not always present) to a second class of peripheral positions (which otherwise often fail to project). The divisions that follow from this initial characterization are then mirrored by a range of secondary distinctions that trace the same divide: the operations grouped together as A-movements, for instance, typically share three further properties. (*i*) They reshape the possibilities of pronominal coreference, often avoiding reconstruction for Condition C and yielding new paths of variable binding (Reinhart, 1983; Lasnik, 1999a), (*ii*) they feed higher operations of the A-syntax, positioning their targets to receive Case, trigger agreement, and undergo later steps of A-movement (May, 1979; Rezac, 2003), and (*iii*) in the ATTRACT-based framework of Chomsky 2001, they strictly target the closest DP.

The analytical framework that follows from this divide is one that has been extended to achieve impressive results, delivering a path to capture recurrent generalizations on movement and its place in the syntax. But given the scale and depth of the predictions it drives, it is no surprise that this theory has come to a series of increasingly complicated questions as it has begun to unfold: on the nature of the divide, on the origins of its component parts, and on the mechanisms that draw them together and split them up to yield the attested typology of phrasal movements. One of these surrounds the specific hypothesis in (1).

(1) *The Generalization on Category*
A-movement does not target PPs. (see, e.g., Polinsky 2016; Safir 2019)

This generalization on category fits together with a wider network of restrictions to suggest that the mechanisms of the A-syntax are strictly relativized to interact with DPs: the operations beneath Case-assignment and agreement, for instance, seem to ignore PPs as well (Lasnik, 1999b; Chomsky, 2001; Bošković, 2002; Bruening, 2014). But even so, there exist a series of effects to suggest that this constraint is not absolute. Many languages, to begin, allow dative and ergative arguments to raise into the usual A-positions of subjects (Zaenen *et al.*, 1985; Sigurðsson, 1989; Davison, 2004; Anand & Nevins, 2006): steps that would violate this constraint if such arguments were strictly encased in PPs (Řezáč, 2008). More pressing, however, is a challenge that emerges in the arena of LOCATIVE INVERSION: there is near-consensus that the PP in (2) must undergo some type of A-movement in English (Bresnan, 1977; Coopmans, 1989; Culicover, 1991; Culicover & Levine, 2001), even if it later raises to the Ā-domain (Bresnan, 1994; Rizzi & Shlonsky, 2006; Den Dikken, 2006).

(2) *Locative Inversion: A-Movement of PPs*
[$_{PP}$ *Under the bed*] lived a relatively innocuous demon.

The goal of this paper, then, is to study the status of the constraint in (1) through close investigation of another pattern of this type: one that emerges in Mandar, a language of Central Indonesia. This language has a class of complex PPs that are built around directional and locative prepositions (3a), and it allows these phrases to surface in the positions that would normally feed absolutive agreement with T^0 (3b). In this context, it becomes possible to strip away the usual source of abstract Case in the PP, and in the ensuing configuration, the complements of P^0 raise to the edge of the PP and begin to interact with T^0.

(3) *Mandar: Absolutive Agreement Into the PP*

a. Lamba i iCicci' [$_{PP}$ **dai' di boyan-na**].
go [INTRANSITIVE] 3ABS NAME up to house-her
'Chichi' went up to her house.'

b. Naola i iCicci' [$_{PP}$ **boyan-na** [$_{P'}$ **dai'** ___].
go [TRANSITIVE] 3ABS NAME house-her up
'Chichi' went up to her house.'

As we work through the syntax of this second construction, we will find that it runs almost exactly parallel to the English pseudopassive in (4a): it requires the complement of P^0 to raise to a middle-field subject position, albeit covertly, on its path up to interact with T^0. But this step of A-movement is prefigured, somewhat surprisingly, by a process that raises the full PP to the edge of the *voice*P: one that, in specific contexts, we can overtly see (4b).

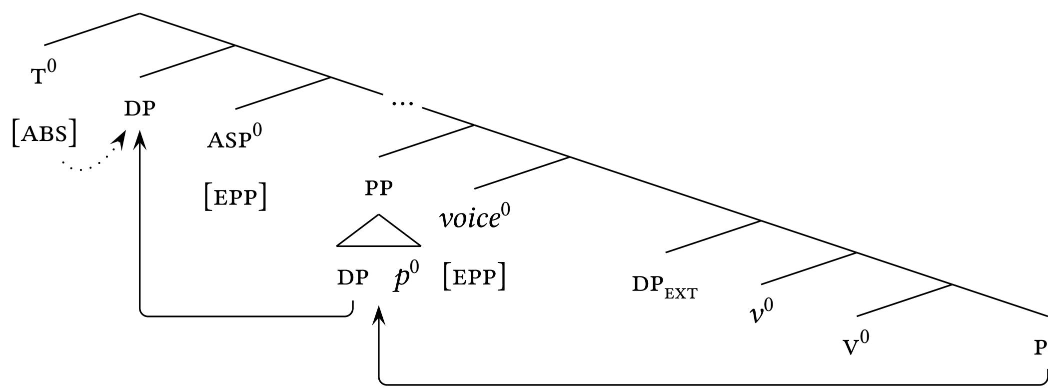
(4) *Mandar: Pseudopassive via A-Movement of PP*

a. Her house was gone up to ___.

b. Rua i [$_{voiceP}$ [$_{PP}$ **boyan-na dai'** __] diola __] AE!
once 3ABS house-her up go [PASSIVE] PRT
'Her house was once gone up to, I'm telling you!'

The analytical task that falls to us is thus to work out the syntax beneath this step—and more specifically, to understand what systems must conspire to allow A-movement of PPs. The core of the analysis will emerge from the following connection to position: in Mandar, PPs can only be targeted by the steps of A-movement that proceed to the edge of the *voice*P. By studying the contexts that force overt A-movement to the subject position in the middle field, then, we will see that these clauses show the syntax in (5): when *voice*^{0} attracts a PP, the higher heads of the A-syntax must then subextract the DP to feed interaction with T^0, often overtly stranding the p^0 in SPEC,*voice*P.

(5) *The Asymmetry in Category*



To capture these effects, I propose that the A-syntax acquires the capacity to attract PPs exclusively at the edge of the phase: an analysis which allows us to link these effects to a wider positional breakdown of the requirement for A-attraction to target the closest DP. The ultimate force of these facts, I will argue, is to suggest that the phase edge must license the emergence of a second type to A-attraction: one that diverges from the usual profile of A-movement with respect to this constraint, freely skipping intervening DPs and freely targeting PPs, but feeds the higher systems of the A-syntax in a completely regular way.

The remainder of this paper is structured as follows. Section 2 introduces Mandar and the relevant types of PPs, then lays out the PP-internal shifts in Case-licensing and the steps of movement that begin to unfold in the contexts that license interaction with T^0. Section 3 then demonstrates that interaction between the complements of P^0 and T^0 must be fed by a step of A-movement which pied-pipes the full PP to SPEC,*voice*P. Section 4 shows that this type of pied-piping is restricted to the edge of the *voice*P, failing to emerge under corresponding patterns of A-attraction into the TP, and draws a link to a breakdown in locality at that edge. Section 5 then concludes with a reflection on the consequences for locative inversion, which seems to involve parallel A-movement of PPs.

2 Background

Mandar is an Austronesian language spoken by 400,000 people in the Indonesian province of West Sulawesi. It belongs to the South Sulawesi subfamily of Malayo-Polynesian (Esser, 1938; Mills, 1975; Grimes & Grimes, 1987) and has been the subject of a range of descriptive studies in Indonesian (Pelenkahu *et al.*, 1983; Sikki *et al.*, 1987; Muthalib & Sangi, 1991), and it can be productively compared to the other language of the South Sulawesi subgroup, which have been described in a much larger body of work (Friberg, 1991, 1996; Strømme, 1994; Matti, 1994; Valkama, 1995a,b; Jukes, 2006; Lee, 2008; Kaufman, 2008; Laskowske, 2016; Finer, 1994, 1997, 1998, 1999; Béjar, 1999). This paper describes the standard variety of the language, spoken on the coast between the cities of Polewali and Majene (Grimes & Grimes, 1987), and its central results emerge from elicitation with a single speaker, Jupri Talib, with whom I have been working since 2018.[1]

Mandar is a verb-initial language that requires nominal arguments to surface in a rigid order in the extended VP: the EXTERNAL ARGUMENT (EXT) must precede the INTERNAL ARGUMENT (INT) and in ditransitives, the INT must precede the APPLIED ARGUMENT (GOAL). I will refer to this order as VSOD. The language shows no morphological case-marking, but it has a system of agreement: the EXT controls ergative agreement on transitive and ditransitive verbs, while the transitive INT and ditransitive GOAL are targeted by absolutive agreement enclitics in second position. These properties are shown in example (6).

(6) *The Mandar Clause*

Na-alli-ang	i	[$_{EXT}$	iKaco'	]	[$_{INT}$	iGary	]	[$_{GOAL}$	iCicci'	]	dionging.
3ERG-buy-APPL	3ABS		NAME			NAME			NAME		yesterday

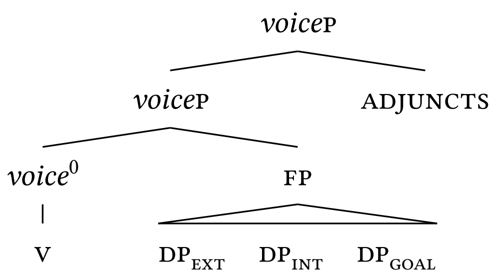
'Kacho' bought Gary (a cat) for Chichi' yesterday.'

2.1 The Mandar Clause

We can begin to map out the syntax of the clause with a fact of constituency. In the general case in Mandar, the VSOD string forms a tight constituent: one that can be seen in a range of ways in both the syntax and the surface prosody. Brodkin 2025b identifies this constituent as the *voice*P and thus proposes that clauses like (6) show the syntax in (7).

[1] GLOSSING: ABS: absolutive, ACC: accusative, AF: agent focus, APPL: applicative, ERG: ergative, FIN: finite; FUT: future; GEN: genitive; NOM: nominative; PL: plural; TRANS: transitive. SPELLING: <c, ng, '>: /t͡ʃ, ŋ, ʔ/.

(7) *The VSOD Constituent*



From this position, Brodkin 2025c argues that the verb reaches its high position through a process of head-movement that carries it through the extended VP. Within this space, the surface prosody reveals the existence of two smaller projections, and these correspond neatly to two lower heads that are morphologically exponed in the verbal complex (Brodkin, 2025b, To Appear): *appl*^{0}, which introduces GOALS (Pylkkänen, 2008), and v^0, which introduces the EXT (Collins, 2005; Merchant, 2013). On the view that the verb raises to the head at the very edge of the extended VP, we thus arrive at the analysis in (8): one that derives the consistent and stable order of VSO(D) from head-movement up to *voice*^{0}.

(8) *VSOD Order: Head-Movement of the Verb*

[$_{voice\text{P}}$ *voice*^{0} [$_{v\text{P}}$ DP$_{\text{EXT}}$ v^0 [$_{appl\text{P}}$ *appl*^{0} [$_{\text{VP}}$ V DP$_{\text{INT}}$] DP$_{\text{GOAL}}$]]]

With this much place, we can now turn to the middle field. Above the *voice*P, Mandar has a closed class of five rigidly ordered elements that mark polarity and aspect: the negator *ndang*, the experiential perfect *rua*, the completive *yari*, the habitual *byasa*, and the terminative *pura* (9). Brodkin 2025a establishes that these elements form a coherent class of functional heads in the middle field, and I will refer to them as AUXILIARIES below.

(9) *The System of Auxiliaries*

[$_{\text{POLP}}$ Ndang **i**	[$_{\text{AUXP2}}$ rua	[$_{\text{AUXP1}}$ yari	[$_{voice\text{P}}$ na-baca	]]]].
not 3ABS	ever	DID	3ERG-read	

'She never DID read it.'

The absolutive agreement enclitics follow the highest overt AUX, as across the subfamily (Strømme, 1994; Friberg, 1996; Finer, 1999); otherwise they follow the verb. This pattern then falls together with several others to suggest that absolutive agreement sits high in the Mandar clause: for instance, it surfaces in all finite clauses, shows allomorphy conditioned by C^0 (10a), and vanishes in the clauses that lack the higher structure of the middle field—such as control complements like (10b). It contrasts in these respects with ergative agreement, which is strictly verb-adjacent, shows no parallel type of allomorphy, vanishes in clauses that lack transitive verbs, and appears in reduced complements of these types. As a result, Brodkin 2022 argues that absolutive agreement sits in T^0 and ergative agreement sits in *voice*^{0}.

(10) *Absolutive Agreement: High*

a. Pole **a'** yau marondong **anna'-u** mala mu-ita.
come 1ABS 1SG tomorrow so.that-1ABS.IRREALIS can 2ERG-see
'I'll come tomorrow so that you might see me.'

b. Tapi' batabata **a'** $[_{voiceP}$ na-ita (***a'**) kindo'-u].
but reluctant 1ABS 3ERG-see 1ABS mom-1GEN
'But I'm reluctant for my mom to see $\_\__{\text{PRO}}$.'

This asymmetry in agreement then correlates with a fundamental fact of the A-syntax. In Mandar, the types of structural privilege that are typically associated with subjects must fall to the DP that triggers absolutive agreement (the transitive INT and ditransitive GOAL): henceforth, the absolutive DP (Brodkin, 2022, 2025c). The immediate force of this claim is to establish that Mandar shows an A-syntax familiar from languages of two other types: (*i*) the network of ergative languages that show High Absolutive syntax (Coon *et al.*, 2014), where absolutive DPs raise above ergative DPs to receive the highest source of Case, and (*ii*) the languages of Western Indonesia and the Philippines, where parallel *voice systems* force the same types of arguments to raise to the highest A-positions in the clause (though these are not always discussed in ergative terms: Guilfoyle *et al.* 1992; Aldridge 2004; Nomoto 2013; Legate 2014; Erlewine 2018; Erlewine & Sommerlot To Appear; Nie 2020). At a deeper level, however, it reveals that the basic word order of VSOD masks a rich syntax of subjecthood that is canonically covert: one that raises the absolutive DP through a series of subject positions in the extended VP and the middle field along the rough lines in (11). This is a system that we will slowly unpack and draw into focus as our work proceeds.

(11) *The Covert Syntax of Subjecthood*

$$[_{\text{TP}}\ \text{T}^0\ [_{\text{AspP}}\ \cancel{\text{DP}}_{\text{INT}}\ \text{Asp}^0\ [_{voiceP}\ \cancel{\text{DP}}_{\text{INT}}\ voice^0\ [_{vP}\ \text{DP}_{\text{EXT}}\ [_{\text{VP}}\ \text{DP}_{\text{INT}}\ ]\ ]\ ]\ ]\ ]$$

2.2 Two Types of Prepositional Phrase

Our real work begins in the prepositional domain with the rough internal syntax of the PP. Mandar has a preposition *di* that continues a locative element from Proto-Austronesian (Blust, 2015), widespread across Sulawesi (Mills, 1975; Mead, 1998) and western Indonesia. In Mandar, however, this preposition only appears without higher functional structure in a very limited set of contexts: mostly in the types of temporal expression in (12).

(12) *The Low Preposition di*

a. Matamba' i urang [$_{PP}$ **di** bongi].
heavy 3ABS rain P night
'The rain was heavy at night.' Friberg & Jerniati 2000, 252

b. [$_{PP}$ **Di** gena'] pa anna' meoro' i dio di kadera, iSitti.
P earlier and sit 3ABS there P chair NAME
'Since earlier, Sitti has been sitting in a chair.' Sikki *et al.* 1987, 836

The typical spatial PPs of the language are instead built around two parts: the lower P^0 *di* and a higher preposition that denotes the position of the location relative to the speaker. This second class contains elements of two types: some denote relative height (*dyaya* 'up,' *diong* 'down') or position with respect to boundaries (*lalang* 'inside,' and *lai'* 'outside'), while others denote relative distance alone (*indi* 'right here', *dini* 'here,' *dio* 'there,' and *diting* 'over there'). All of these elements are functional heads and they sit along the spine of the extended PP (Van Riemsdijk, 1990; Jackendoff, 1990; Rauh, 1993; Ayano, 2001). As such, I will refer to them as LOCATIVE PREPOSITIONS. Some examples are given in (13).

(13) *The Higher Locative Prepositions*

a. **Dyaya** di buttu', **diong** di kalo'bo', **lalang** di lamari, **lai'** di toko
up P hill down P hole inside P cabinet outside P store
'Up in the hills, down in a hole, inside in the cabinet, outside at the store.'

b. **Indi** di lima-u, **dini** di boya'-u, **dio** di boyan-na, **diting** di pasar
here P hand-1GEN here P house-1GEN there P house-3GEN there P market
'Here in my hand, here in my house, there in her house, there in the market'

As the locative prepositions denote position relative to the speaker, they differ from the spatial prepositions which denote position relative to other arguments: for instance, *olo* 'in front of' and *bao* 'on top of.' These are the elements identified as AXIAL PARTS by Svenonius (2006, 2008, 2010) (see also Watanabe 1993; Jackendoff 1996), and in the syntax, they can be distinguished from the locative prepositions in two ways: they directly select nominals and they must follow *di* (which must in turn be embedded beneath a locative P).

(14) *Locative Prepositions: Distinct from Axial Parts*

Dio... [**di olo** boyang / **di bao** ate' / **di se'de'** pasar / **di pondo'** masigi']
there P front house P top roof P side market P back mosque
'There in front of the house / atop the roof / next to the market / behind the mosque'

The locative prepositions and *di* are both strictly obligatory in canonical spatial PPS. Outside the registers most consciously influenced by Indonesian, where the typical spatial PPS contain only the homophonous preposition *di*, it is impossible to drop the locative P. Outside a fine network of contexts to be studied below, it is equally impossible to drop *di*.

(15) *Spatial Prepositional Phrases: Require Both Parts*

a. Pole a' ummorong [*(**diong**) *(**di**) uwai].
just 1ABS swim down P water
'I was just swimming *(down) in the river.' Friberg & Jerniati 2000, 224

b. U-anna i [*(**dyaya**) *(**di**) meya].
1ERG-put 3ABS up P table
'I put it *(up) on the table.'

This requirement is then matched by a series of effects to suggest that the locative PS are functional heads that select *di*. First, they cannot iterate: every spatial PP requires exactly one locative P (16a). Second, their positions are rigid: they cannot shift right and must immediately precede *di* (16b). Third, they impose requirements of adjacency on the following *di*-PP: for instance, they prevent it from scrambling (16c), though it is freely possible to scramble the entire PP (Brodkin, 2025b).

(16) *Locative Prepositions: Functional Heads*

a. [$_{voiceP}$ *Ummorong i [**diong** **diting** di uwai]].
swim 3ABS down there P water
INTENDED: 'She swam down there in the river.'

b. [$_{voiceP}$ *Ummorong i [di uwai **diting**]].
swim 3ABS P water there
INTENDED: 'She swam in the river there.'

c. [$_{voiceP}$ *Ummorong i [**diong** ____]] dionging [di uwai].
swim 3ABS down yesterday P water
INTENDED 'She swam down there yesterday in the river.'

Fourth, the locative PS can be prefixed with a locative pronoun *in-*, syntactically similar to the English *there*, which forces the complete suppression of the following *di*-PP. This pronoun appears in contexts of deixis and combines with both types of locative P.

(17) *Prefixal Locative Pronouns: Suppress di-PPs*

a. Matindo i [**il**-lalang (*di kamar)]
sleep 3ABS there-in P room
'She's sleeping therein.'

b. U-anna i [**in**-dio (*di meya)]
1ERG-put 3ABS there-there P table
'I put it there-thereupon'

Fifth, the locative PS interact with a second class of prepositions that seem to sit higher in the extended PP. These are the elements that denote PATHS, and they encode both the position of an argument relative to the speaker and the direction of motion towards or away from it. Like the locative PS, these elements seem to select PPS headed by *di* (18a), they host *in-* (18b), they cannot drop or iterate, and they must immediately precede their *di*-PPS. I will refer to them as the DIRECTIONAL PREPOSITIONS.

(18) *The Directional Prepositions*

a. Lolong i [tarrus sau **di** sasi'].
flow 3ABS straight outward P sea
'It flows straight out to the sea.' Friberg & Jerniati 2000, 215

b. Bemme i [**it-tama** (*di kalo'bo')].
fall 3ABS there-into P hole
'It fell thereinto.'

The directional and locative PS show the types of interaction that are typical of functional heads adjacent in a single extended projection. First, they never co-occur: when directionals appear, locatives are suppressed (19a). Second, they come in pairs: almost every preposition in each class has a counterpart in the other, aside from the ablative directionals *pole* 'from' and *sung* 'out of' and the extra-proximate locative *indi* 'right here' (19b). Third, there is a context where two of the locative PS seem to supplete to their corresponding directional forms: it is impossible for the pronoun *in-* to combine with *dyaya* 'up' and *diong* 'down,' and the meanings that would emerge from these combinations are instead expressed with the directional forms *dai'* 'upward' and *naung* 'downward' (19c).

(19) *The Directional-Locative Relationship*

a. Na-laccar i [tama (***lalang**) di kamar].
3ERG-throw 3ABS into inside P room
'He threw it into the room.'

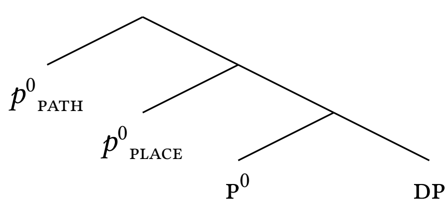
b.

DIRECTIONAL:	dai'	naung	tama	sau	mai	mating	lao
LOCATIVE:	dyaya	diong	lalang	lai'	dini	dio	diting
GLOSS:	up	down	in	out	here	there	out there

c. U-anna i [**in-dai'** / **in-naung** / ***in-dyaya** / ***in-diong**]
1ERG-put 3ABS there-upward / there-downward / thereup / theredown
'I put it up there / down there.'

To capture these patterns, I propose that the Mandar PP shows the rough syntax in (20): it is built from a head PATH^0 that hosts the directionals, a lower head PLACE^0 that hosts the locatives, and then a final head P^0 that hosts *di*. The result is a structure familiar from much work on the extended PP (Kracht 2002, 2008; also Cinque & Rizzi 2010), and it is one that fits neatly with all the patterns that we have seen so far. As the typical spatial PPs require locative Ps, I propose that they always project up to PLACE^0 (unlike the temporal PPs that only host *di*). In this context, I assume that the language requires overt locative Ps because the native lexicon lacks a freestanding null exponent of PLACE^0 (though the loan strata may contain one borrowed from Indonesian). In directional PPs, at last, I propose that PLACE^0 is projected but morphologically suppressed: PLACE^0 undergoes head-movement into the higher head PATH^0 and the two heads are spelled out as directional portmanteaux.

(20) *The Complex PP*



In the system that follows from these parts, a special role falls to the head P^0. Following Grimshaw 1991, I take the prepositional sequence to fall in the extended projection of N^0, with P^0 marking the juncture between the two parts of that spine. As a result, I propose that P^0 must be present whenever the higher p^0s combine with nominal material: even when the locative pronoun *in-* forces the suppression of *di*, for instance, I assume that it is selected by P^0 (which is then morphologically suppressed in the complex head built by raising from D^0 to p^0). This hypothesis will be central to the following investigation of P^0.

2.3 Prepositional Inversion

The effects of interest emerge below syntactically transitive verbs of motion and position, which typically select nominal INTs. This class of verbs in Mandar is open and large, and it includes many roots that only show this syntax, like *ola* "go" (21a) and *engei* "be in" (21b).

(21) *Transitive Verbs of Path and Place*

a. Byasa i u-ola [$_{DP}$ tangngalalang kaiang].
usually 3ABS 1ERG-go along road grand
'Usually I take the highway.'

b. Apana sata mu-engei i [$_{DP}$ kamar-mu]?
Why always 2ERG-be in 3ABS room-2GEN
'Why are you always in your room?'

It also includes many verbs that show transitive-intransitive alternations built around the locative applicative suffix *-i* (which continues the Proto-Austronesian locative voice (Ross, 1995; Zobel *et al.*, 2002); on its function elsewhere in South Sulawesi, see Jukes 2006, 293-303). The root *lamba* 'walk,' for instance, typically takes the intransitive form in (22a) and selects a path PP, but it can also be transitivized with *-i* to select a nominal INT (22b).

(22) *Transitive Applicative Verbs*

a. Lamba i iAli [$_{PP}$ sau di pasar].
walk 3ABS NAME out P market
'Ali walked out to the market.'

b. Na-lamba-i i iAli [$_{DP}$ tangngalalang].
3ERG-walk-APPL 3ABS NAME road
'Ali walked the road.'

Beneath these transitive verbs, it is systematically possible to nest the INT within a PP. This shift will raise questions about the syntax of subjecthood in Section 3, as its immediate effect is to create clauses that lack absolutive DPs. What matters most at present, however, is its effect on the system of the absolutive agreement: the resultant clauses always contain the third-person enclitic *i*, suggesting that the ergative EXT does not interact with T^0.

(23) *Transitive Verbs: Complements Nested in PPs*

Apana sata mu-engei i [$_{pp}$ **lalang di** kamar-mu]?
Why always 2ERG-be in 3ABS inside P room-2GEN
'Why are you always inside in your room?'

This configuration is important for a shift that it licenses in the apparent absolutive PP. Mandar is a language that lacks non-human articles, and it requires definite nominals to surface bare when their referents are contextually unique but not anaphoric: when *weakly definite*, in the sense of Schwarz 2009 (24a). The result is that bare nominals typically support both definite and indefinite readings, even inside of absolutive PPs (24b).

(24) *Bare Nominals: Definite and Indefinite Readings*

a. Na-oro'-i i [$_{DP}$ pulo].
3ERG-sit-APPL 3ABS island
'He's on the island.'

b. Na-oro'-i i [$_{PP}$ lai' di pulo].
3ERG-sit-APPL 3ABS out P island
'He's out on the island/an island.'

When definite nominals are embedded in these absolutive PPs, however, the language allows *di* to be suppressed (25a). This shift forces a definite interpretation and is only ever licensed in the PPs built around arguments that would otherwise interact with T^0. In the path complements to *lamba* 'go,' then, it is impossible without the transitivizer *-i* (25b).

(25) *Di-Suppression in Absolutive PPs*

a. Na-lamba-i i [$_{PP.ABS}$ tama __ **pasar**].
3ERG-go-APPL 3ABS into P market
'He went into the market.'

b. Lamba i [$_{PP.NON-ABS}$ tama *(**di**) **pasar**].
go 3ABS into P market
'He went into the market.'

In the same context, *di* can also be lost before two more elements that seem to sit in D^0. The first is the proprial article *i*, which surfaces before referential human names (26a). The second are demonstratives like *de* 'this and *do* 'that' (26b), which also play a role in the system of definiteness (Brodkin, To Appear): *do*, for instance, is required to appear above most types of explicitly anaphoric nominals (the *strong definites* of Schwarz 2009).

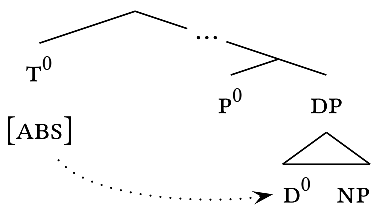
(26) *Di-Suppression: Prenonominal Determiners*

a. Na-indong-i i [$_{PP.ABS}$ lao ___ **i** Kaco'].
3ERG-run-APPL 3ABS to P D^0 NAME
'He ran to Kacho'.'

b. Na-oro'-i i [$_{PP.ABS}$ dio ___ **do** ka'dera o].
3ERG-sit-APPL 3ABS there P that chair there
'He sat there in that chair there.'

We thus arrive at a delicate interaction between the functional spine of the NP and T^0: when PP structure is introduced around nominals that should otherwise trigger absolutive agreement, and when those nominals are bare weak definites or when they host prenominal articles or demonstratives, it is possible to suppress *di.* I propose that this shift turns on an interaction between T^0 and D^0. On this view, the class of nominals that license suppression is defined by the presence of a single functional head that hosts the demonstratives, the proprial article, and a null weak definite article: D^0. When P^0 surfaces above this head, I propose, it becomes possible to suppress *di* in the contexts that license interaction between these DP and the agreement probe in T^0 (which never targets bare NPs).

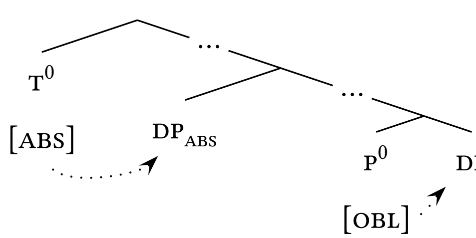
(27) *Di-Suppression: D and T*



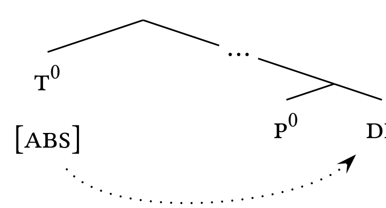
We thus arrive at a type of complementarity between P^0 and T^0: taking suppression to trace a shift in the syntax, it would seem that something can be lost in the PP when its complement can be rescued by T^0. The ensuing interaction can be understood neatly in terms of Case (Vergnaud, 1977). Following Van Riemsdijk 1990, I propose that the complements of P^0 are licensed by the lowest head in the extended PP: in Mandar, *di.* In the contexts of suppression, however, I propose that P^0 is filled by a second element that has no phonological form and no ability to license a complement DP. In the usual case, where these complements must receive Case in the PP, the language requires *di* (28a). But in the contexts that license interaction with T^0, we begin to see this second P^0 (28b).

(28) *Case and the Suppression of Di*

a. *Regular Contexts: Di*



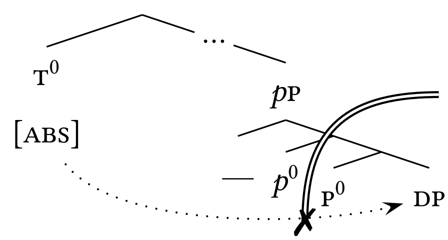
b. *Absolutive Contexts:* $P_{\varnothing}$



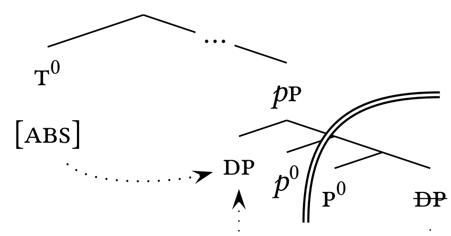
We can now push this analysis further with a turn to the matter of visibility in the PP. Since Van Riemsdijk 1978, it has been widely assumed that the heads of the clausal spine cannot reach into the PP: complements to P^0 should be inaccessible to heads like T^0 (29a). The central motivation for this view is a fact of displacement: when complements to P^0 raise to positions outside the PP, they must pass through an escape hatch at the edge of the extended PP. This position follows naturally from the hypothesis that the extended PP forms a *phase* (Kayne, 1999, 2004; Abels, 2003, 2012; Bošković, 2004), and on the view that the locality domains for movement are identical to those of AGREE (Chomsky 2000; *cf.* Bošković 2003, 2007; Bhatt 2005; Keine 2017), it delivers a secondary result: if the complement DPs in this system interact with T^0, we should expect them to raise to SPEC,*p*P (29b).

(29) *Seeing Into the PP*

a. *Phase-Based Locality*



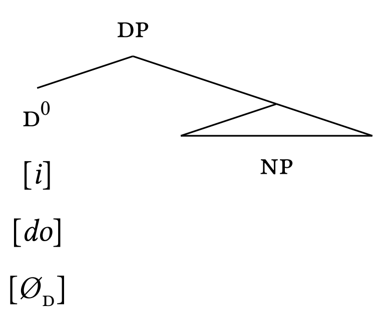
b. *Raising to the Edge*



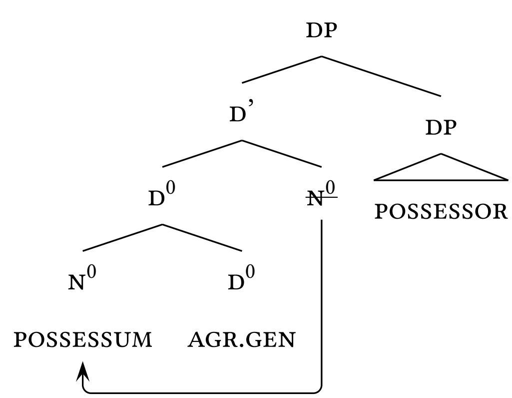
It is thus a telling fact that there is explicit linear evidence for the movement in (29b). In the PPs above, the null P^0 has visibly preceded the proprial articles and demonstratives, and I assume that it also immediately precedes the null weak definite D^0 (30a). But there is another class of nominals in the language that raise into the head D^0, breaking the linear adjacency between this head and P^0 (30b). These are the nominals that are possessed, which host agreement with a possessor in a rightward SPEC,DP (Brodkin, To Appear).

(30) *The Linear Order of D*

a. *Head-Initial Orders*



b. *Non-Initial Orders*



When we put nominals of this second type in absolutive PPs, the facts of order reverse. Here as above, it is possible to suppress or retain *di* (31a). But when *di* is suppressed in a context that blocks adjacency between the null P^0 and a following D^0, it becomes impossible for the complement of P^0 to remain in its usual position after the higher P^0. In that context, instead, it is forced to move to the left, yielding the order DP-p^0 (31b). I will refer to this shift as PREPOSITIONAL INVERSION and take it to place its targets in SPEC,*p*P.

(31) *Inversion in the PP*

a. Na-oro'-i i [$_{PP}$ __ dyaya **di** [$_{DP}$ boyan-na iCicci']].
3ERG-sit-APPL 3ABS up P house-3GEN NAME
'He's up in Chichi's house.'

b. Na-oro'-i i [$_{PP}$ [$_{DP}$ boyan-na iCicci'] dyaya **Ø**$_{P}$ __].
3ERG-sit-APPL 3ABS house-3GEN NAME up
'He's up in Chichi's house.'

Prepositional inversion must also apply to names that lack the proprial article *i* (32). There, too, I take P^0-D^0 adjacency to be broken by raising of N^0 to D^0 (Longobardi, 1994).

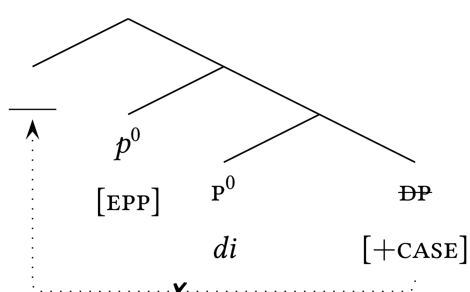
(32) *Inversion: Forced without Prenominal D*

Na-oro'-i i [$_{PP}$ [$_{DP}$ Ma'asar] dyaya **Ø**$_{P}$ __].
3ERG-sit-APPL 3ABS PLACE up
'He's up in Makassar.'

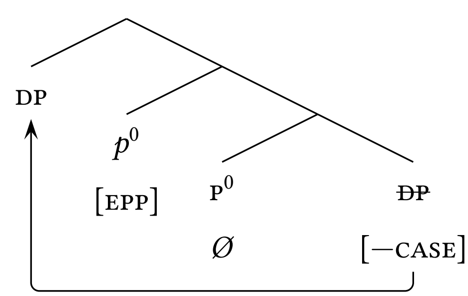
I argue that prepositional inversion reflects a syntactic shift that occurs systematically in the presence of the null P^0. On this view, there is a movement-driving probe that always attempts to attract Caseless nominals to the edge of the extended PP: one that falls on the highest head in that domain and probes no matter the content of P^0. In the presence of *di*, this probe will always fail, yielding the rigid order p^0-P^0-DP (33a). But in contexts of suppression, it finds the Caseless complement of the null P^0 and draws it to SPEC,*p*P (33b).

(33) *The Syntax of Absolutive PPs*

a. *Complements with Case: Low*



b. *Complements without Case: High*



This step of movement must apply overtly whenever the null P^0 is not adjacent to D^0, and we will return to this pattern as we begin to study quantified nominals in Section 3. Whenever this P^0 is adjacent to D^0, however, it must be covert. I propose that the origins of this restriction must lie in the morphology: when the null P^0 is linearized before D^0, it must be concatenated with that head by a postsyntactic step of string-vacuous LOCAL DISLOCATION (Embick & Noyer, 2001). This process forces it to form a morphological constituent with proprial articles (34a), demonstratives (34b), and weak definite D^0s (34), but not the possessive D^0 (34d) or the null article that surfaces with non-human names (34e).

(34) *Local Dislocation: $\text{P}^0 \rightarrow \text{D}^0$*

a. $[_{\text{PP}}$ ___ $[_{\text{DP}}$ $\text{Ø}_{\text{P}} - i$ NP]]

b. $[_{\text{PP}}$ ___ $[_{\text{DP}}$ $\text{Ø}_{\text{P}} - \text{DEM}^0$ NP]]

c. $[_{\text{PP}}$ ___ $[_{\text{DP}}$ $\text{Ø}_{\text{P}} - \text{Ø}_{\text{D.DEF}}$ NP]]

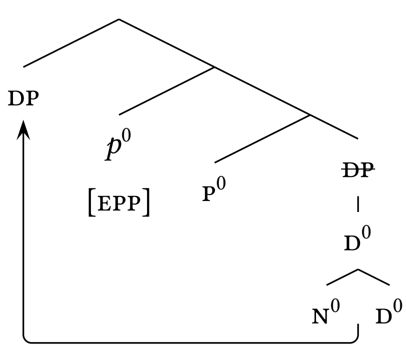
d. $[_{\text{PP}}$ Ø_{P} $[_{\text{DP}}$ NP$-\text{Ø}_{\text{D.AGR}}$]]

e. $[_{\text{PP}}$ Ø_{P} $[_{\text{DP}}$ NP$-\text{Ø}_{\text{D.NAME}}$]]

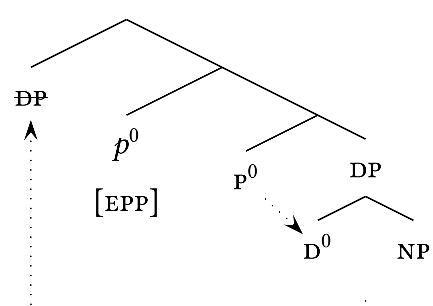
This morphological step must occur at a derivational stage after movement has applied, and when it targets the heads of moved DPs, it creates a tension with the following shape. When the system of chain reduction weighs PPs with the shape in (35a), where the Caseless complement of PP has raised to SPEC,*p*P, it typically deletes the lower DP: a result forced by the general preference to spell out moved elements high (Bobaljik, 2002; Nunes, 2004). But in the structures that show local dislocation, like (35b), the same pattern of deletion would also suppress P^0, which forms a morphological constituent with the lower instance of D^0. In this configuration, then, I propose that the usual pattern of spell-out is blocked—forcing the preservation of the lower DP and masking the regular step of movement to SPEC,*p*P.

(35) *Spelling out Movement to SPEC,pP*

a. *Regular Condition: High*



b. *Local Dislocation: Low*



2.4 Visibility and the Pseudopassive

We thus emerge from the first arc of our investigation with a coherent theory of visibility at the level of the PP: even though this domain is typically opaque to the external heads of the clausal spine, it is possible for absolutive agreement to target the complements of P^0 because they raise to SPEC,*p*P and show a need for Case that renders them visible to T^0.

From this position, we can begin to see a connection from the system at hand to the English phenomenon in (36): one known as the pseudopassive (Hornstein & Weinberg, 1981; Åfarli, 1989; Law, 1998, 2006; Schueler, 2012; Drummond & Kush, 2015; McInnerney, 2022; Hewett, 2025). This is a construction most convincingly attested in English and two varieties of Canadian French (King & Roberge 1990; Roberge & Rosen 1999; King 2000; Therrien 2023; see Klingvall 2012 on the doubtful case of Mainland Scandinavian), and it would seem to force the same kind of interaction between the complement of P^0 and T^0.

(36) *The Pseudopassive*

ATTRACTION

CASE

[$_{TP}$ The carpet T^0 [$_{voiceP}$ was stepped [$_{pP}$ on __]]].

Drawing this link into focus, we can leverage our interim results to reinforce a specific perspective on this second construction: one that turns on the same breakdown of Case and ensuing step of movement in the PP. The facts of Mandar, to begin, fit neatly with the claim that pseudopassivization is licensed by a structural shift internal to the PP: it requires the presence of functional heads that fail to assign Case to the complement DP. (Van Riemsdijk, 1990; Rooryck, 1996; Abels, 2003, 2012; Ramchand & Svenonius, 2004; Truswell, 2009; McInnerney, 2022). In the same vein, they reinforce and extend the corresponding hypothesis that pseudopassivization requires movement to the edge of the extended PP (Van Riemsdijk, 1978). It is thus a satisfying fact that this stance aligns neatly with the facts of Lafontaine French, where Therrien 2023 notes that this process forces morphological augmentation of P^0s like *dans* 'in.' This fact acquires its importance from the hypothesis that movement cannot proceed directly from the complement position of P^0 to SPEC,PP (Abels, 2003, 2012): on that view, this augmentation creates enough distance for the complement DP to successfully raise to the edge of the extended PP (37).

(37) *Lafontaine French: Pseudopassivization → Extra Structure in the PP*

Le ciment	a	été marché	[$_{pP}$ __	*de-dans*	[$_{PP}$ __$_P$	__$_{DP}$	]].
the cement	T^0	was walked		AUGMENT-in			

'The cement was walked in.' Therrien 2023, p118

The real value of this connection, however, emerges from the way that it sharpens and refines the questions that will lead us ahead. Beyond the matter of visibility within the PP, the literature on the pseudopassive has articulated a secondary puzzle on the path up to T^0: what is the external configuration that licenses interaction between that head and the PP?

From the perspective outlined above, we can leverage two patterns in English to make sense of its path. First, P-stranding is only possible from certain positions in English (Postal, 1972; Kayne, 1984; Bennis & Hoekstra, 1985), and there is good evidence to suggest that pseudopassivization can only be launched from PPs that sit very low in the VP (Hornstein & Weinberg, 1981). On the view that adverbs are differentially introduced at dedicated structural heights (Cinque, 1999), for instance, we can note the following split: the PPs that launch this operation can follow adjuncts of manner (38a), but not adjuncts of time (38b). On the view that PPs only follow adverbs when they are extraposed to the right, it would thus seem that they can launch the pseudopassive when extraposed to low positions in the VP but not when shifted out of that domain (Drummond & Kush, 2015).

(38) *Pseudopassivization: Only from within the VP*

a. John was [$_{voiceP}$ spoken __$_{PP}$ sternly [$_{PP}$ to __]].

b. *John was [$_{voiceP}$ spoken __$_{PP}$ yesterday] [$_{PP}$ to __].

This conclusion then lines up with a second effect to suggest that pseudopassivization must be mediated by a functional head in the extended VP. English has a middle voice (39a), and it is natural to assume that it is built around a set of nonactive functional heads in the VP (Alexiadou & Anagnostopoulou, 2004). On the analysis that we have built so far, it would seem that these heads must block the interaction between PPs and T^0 (39b): pseudopassivization cannot proceed from middle-voice VPs (Roberts, 1987; Fagan, 1988; Pesetsky, 1996; Postal, 2004), even though there is nothing in these environments that should rule out the requisite types of structurally deficient PPs (as compared to the accounts, inapplicable to Mandar, where Case in the PP is only suppressed through a relationship with the passive v^0: Hornstein & Weinberg 1981; Law 1998, 2006; Hewett 2025).

(39) *Pseudopassivization: Blocked in the Middle*

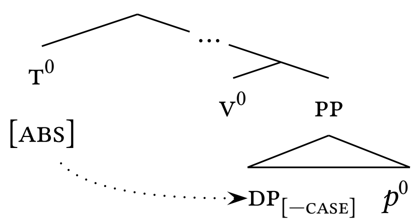
a. Walls like this don't [$_{voiceP.MIDDLE}$ deface [$_{DP}$ __] all that easily].

b. *Walls like this don't [$_{voiceP.MIDDLE}$ write [$_{PP}$ on __] all that easily].

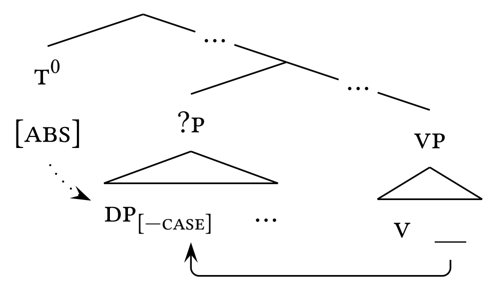
These facts suggest that there is more to this process than direct interaction between T^0 and a lower PP (*pace* Truswell 2009; McInnerney 2022), along the lines in (40a). Instead, they suggest that pseudopassivization must be fed by an intermediate step that is mediated by the functional heads of the extended VP (40b): reanalysis (Hornstein & Weinberg 1981; Radford 1981; van Riemsdijk & Williams 1986; Baker 1988) or, in modern terms, movement to an A-position that feeds contact with T^0 (Drummond & Kush, 2015).

(40) *The Path Toward T*

a. *Rejected: Direct Interaction*



b. *Proposal: Intermediate Step*



Drawing these results back up to the level of theory, we arrive at a broader perspective that fits naturally with the wider shape of the A-syntax and the theory of absolute locality. On the hypothesis that the extended VP defines a phase, to begin, it follows that the targets of the pseudopassive must be drawn to the edge in order to raise further to SPEC,TP (and on the claim that A-movement must pass through the edge, see Sauerland 2003). In the wake of the VP-internal subject hypothesis (Fukui & Speas, 1986; Koopman & Sportiche, 1988), in turn, it seems natural to imagine that these arguments are gradually raised to SPEC,TP by a series of interactions with the heads of the spine, passing through a string of A-positions that deliver the typical properties of subjects on the way. And on the understanding that the syntax of objecthood emerges gradually in much the same way (Johnson, 1991; Collins & Thráinsson, 1996; McCloskey, 2017), it follows that they may well be led to differ from the nominal INTS selected by V^0 by the derivational path that they follow through the VP. The result is a path to see past the classical objections to reanalysis (Baltin & Postal, 1996) and derive the shape of the pseudopassive in a theoretically integrated way.

We thus return to our study of Mandar with two lines of argumentation—one internal to English and one general to the theory—that the pathway toward interaction with T^0 must run through the functional spine of the extended VP. From this point, we can shift toward the next stage of our work with our sights set on the syntax of the Mandar *voice*P—and more specifically, the nature of attraction to the edge of the clause-internal phase.

3 Movement to the Edge

Our work begins from a general puzzle of VP-level locality: if phases are opaque to AGREE, how can T^0 assign Case to the absolutive arguments that seem to stay within the *voice*P? The natural solution, first put forward by Aldridge 2004, is presented in (41): the absolutive argument raises covertly to the edge of the *voice*P. This type of movement has since been widely proposed in verb-initial languages that show High Absolutive syntax (Coon *et al.*, 2014), including many of Indonesia and the Philippines (Nomoto 2013; Erlewine 2018; Erlewine & Lim 2023; Erlewine & Sommerlot To Appear; Nie 2020; Ting 2023), and the case for this step in Mandar is decisive and direct (Brodkin, 2022, 2025c). The task of this section is thus to review the language-internal arguments for the movement in (41), establish its interaction with regular PPs, then advance to the suppression of *di*.

(41) *The Covert Syntax of Subjecthood*

$[_{\text{TP}}$ T^0 $[_{voiceP}$ $\cancel{\text{DP}}_{\text{INT}}$ $voice^0$ $[_{vP}$ DP_{EXT} $[_{\text{VP}}$ DP_{INT} $]$ $]$ $]$ $]$

3.1 The Low Subject Position

Mandar has a subordinating preposition *mau* "though" which typically introduces the type of complement clause in (42): one that lacks absolutive agreement. Brodkin 2025a shows that these clauses lack all functional structure above the level of the *voice*P, and as a result, they will allow us to isolate and study the lower syntax of the absolutive DP.

(42) *Non-Finite Complements of Mau "Though"*

Mau	$[_{voiceP}$	sata	di-ita	dio	di	bar],	masskripsi	i	de'	iAli
though		always	PASS-see	there	P	bar	dissertate	3ABS	allegedly	NAME

'Though always seen [—FIN] at the bar, Ali is allegedly writing a dissertation.'

Unlike the non-finite complement of control verbs, these clauses license the appearance of overt absolutive DPs (43a). As a result, it seems fair to posit the path to licensing in (43b): they allow the absolutive DP to receive Case from the subordinating P^0.

(43) *Though-Complements and Case*

a.

Mau	$[_{voiceP}$	na-yolo-ang	$[_{\text{S}}$ iKaco']	$[_{\text{O}}$ lukisang]	$[_{\text{D}}$ **iCicci'**]],
though		3ERG-promise-APPL	NAME	painting	NAME

'Though Kacho' showed [—FIN] Chichi' the paintings,'

b. $[_{\text{PP}}$ mau_{P^0} $[_{voiceP}$ v DP_{EXT} V DP_{INT} DP_{GOAL}]]

From this position, we can turn to the patterns of variable binding that emerge in the presence of the quantifier *nasang* “every:” a head that follows its associated DP in *voice*PS of this type. This type of quantification licenses patterns of binding that track C-command and ignore linear order (Brodkin 2022), and we can see this fact in the behavior of the ditransitive EXT and INT. When quantified with *nasang*, the EXT can bind into the INT (44a). The INT, however, cannot bind into the EXT (44b). This fact follows naturally from the view that the EXT originates and remains above the INT in the ditransitive *voice*P.

(44) *Variable Binding in Mandar*

a. Mau [$_{voiP}$ na-yolo-ang [$_{S}$ pallukis **nasang**] [$_{O}$ lukisang-na *pro*] [$_{D}$ iCicci']],
though 3ERG-show-APPL painter every painting-3GEN her NAME
'Though every$_{i,j}$ painter showed [−FIN] Chichi' her$_{i}$ painting,'

b. Mau [$_{voiP}$ na-yolo-ang [$_{S}$ pallukis-na *pro*] [$_{O}$ lukisang **nasang**] [$_{D}$ iCicci']],
though 3ERG-show-APPL painter-3GEN its painting every NAME
'Though its$_{*i,j}$ painter showed [−FIN] Chichi' every$_{i}$ painting,'

We then see the same type of asymmetry between the ditransitive INT and GOAL: when the GOAL is quantified, it can bind into the preceding INT (45a), but when the INT is quantified, it cannot bind into the following GOAL (45b). We can understand this asymmetry in the same way: in ditransitive *voice*PS, the GOAL originates and remains above the INT.

(45) *Variable Binding: Ditransitive GOAL > INT*

a. Mau [$_{voiP}$ na-yolo-ang [$_{S}$ iCicci'] [$_{O}$ lukisang-na *pro*] [$_{D}$ pallukis **nasang**]],
though 3ERG-show-APPL NAME painting-3GEN her painter every
'Though Chichi' showed [−FIN] every$_{i,j}$ painter her$_{i}$ painting,'

b. Mau [$_{voiP}$ na-yolo-ang [$_{S}$ iCicci'] [$_{O}$ lukisang **nasang**] [$_{D}$ pallukis-na *pro*]],
though 3ERG-show-APPL NAME painting every painter-3GEN its
'Though Chichi' showed [−FIN] its$_{*i,j}$ painter every$_{i}$ painting,'

We can now turn to the key asymmetries in this system, which surround the absolutive DP. The ditransitive GOAL can bind into the EXT (46a), and so can the transitive INT (46b).

(46) *Variable Binding: Absolutive Arguments > EXT*

a. Mau [$_{voiP}$ na-yolo-ang [$_{S}$ sola-na *pro*] [$_{O}$ iCicci'] [$_{D}$ pallukis **nasang**]],
though 3ERG-show-APPL friend-3GEN her NAME painter every
'Though her$_{i,j}$ friend showed [−FIN] every$_{i}$ painter Chichi','

b. Mau [$_{voiP}$ na-solangang [$_{S}$ kindo'-na *pro*] [$_{O}$ sanaeke **nasang**]],
though 3ERG-accompany mom-3GEN her kid every
'Though her$_{i,j}$ mom accompanied [−FIN] every$_{i}$ kid,'

These facts suggest that the stable word order of VSOD masks a regular step of movement to the edge of the *voice*P: one that carries the absolutive DP above all other arguments in the clause and positions it to interact with T^0. On the view that A-movement must be driven by ATTRACT (Chomsky, 1995), Brodkin 2025c proposes that it is driven by a movement-driving feature on the head at the top of the extended VP: *voice*^{0}. As a result, we can understand it to reflect a subject position of sorts: one that must project across every *voice*P and one that defines the highest A-position within the clause-internal phase. For this reason, I will refer to it as the LOW SUBJECT POSITION in the discussion to come.

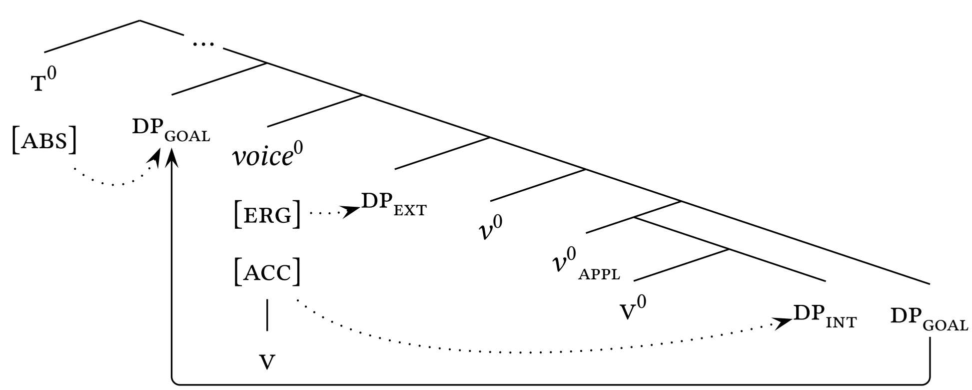
(47) *The Low Subject Position*

a. TRANSITIVE: [$_{\text{TP}}$ T^0 [$_{voiceP}$ ~~DP~~$_{\text{INT}}$ *voice*^{0} [$_{vP}$ DP$_{\text{EXT}}$ [$_{\text{VP}}$ DP$_{\text{INT}}$]]]]

b. DITRANSITIVE: [$_{\text{TP}}$ T^0 [$_{voiceP}$ ~~DP~~$_{\text{GOAL}}$ *voice*^{0} [$_{vP}$ DP$_{\text{EXT}}$ [$_{applP}$ [$_{\text{VP}}$ DP$_{\text{INT}}$] DP$_{\text{GOAL}}$]]]]

From this position, we can now sketch out the rough syntax of the Mandar *voice*P. Starting from the facts of licensing, we have seen that *voice*^{0} agrees with the EXT, yielding the type of "low" ergative agreement familiar from the systems where the absolutive DP interacts with T^0 (Wiltschko, 2006; Coon *et al.*, 2014; Legate, 2014; Brown, 2016). Following Raposo 1987, I take this relationship to Case-license the EXT. Within the *voice*P, however, I assume that Case is never available to the absolutive DP (Bok-Bennema, 1991; Bittner & Hale, 1996a,b). At the derivational moment where *voice*^{0} probes to fill the low subject position, then, it will be forced to attract the INT in transitive *voice*Ps and the GOAL in ditransitives (where it must also Case-license the INT). In the typical ditransitive *voice*P, the result is the syntax in (48): the low subject position sets up the GOAL to receive Case from T^0.

(48) *Ditransitives: GOAL > Low Subject Position for Case*



3.2 The Status of PPs

We can now see how the low subject position interacts with regular PPS. In ditransitives built around the *appl*^{0} *-ang*, it is always possible to embed the GOAL in a regular PP. The result is the apparent DP-PP ditransitive in (49a): one that contrasts with the DP-DP ditransitive and one that I will term the Prepositional Dative Construction (PDC; in contrast to the Double-Object Construction; DOC). As these PP take the positions of absolutive DPS, moreover, they allow the suppression of *di*: a pattern we will return to in Section 3.3 (49b).

(49) *The DP-PP Ditransitive*

a. U-be-ngang i [$_{\text{INT}}$ bunga] [$_{\text{GOAL.PP}}$ **lao di** kotta'-u].
1ERG-give-APPL 3ABS flowers to P girlfriend-1GEN
'I gave flowers to my girlfriend.'

b. U-be-ngang i [$_{\text{INT}}$ bunga] [$_{\text{GOAL.PP}}$ kotta'-u **lao Ø** __].
1ERG-send-APPL 3ABS flower girlfriend-1GEN to
'I gave flowers to my girlfriend.'

In the DP-DP ditransitives where the low subject position attracts the GOAL, we have seen that the binding behavior of the INT is tightly constrained: it cannot bind into the EXT (44b) or the GOAL (45b). In the DP-PP ditransitive, however, the pattern is reversed: if the GOAL is nested in a regular PP, the INT can bind into the EXT (50a) and the GOAL (50b).

(50) *The DP-PP Ditransitive: Ditransitive INT > EXT + GOAL*

a. Mau na-yolo-ang [$_{\text{S}}$ pallukis-na *pro*] [$_{\text{O}}$ lukisang **nasang**] [$_{\text{D}}$ lao di sola-na],
P^0 3ERG-show-APPL painter-3GEN its painting every to P pal-3GEN
'Though its$_{i,j}$ painter showed [−FIN] every$_i$ painting to her friends,'

b. Mau na-yolo-ang [$_{\text{S}}$ *pro*] [$_{\text{O}}$ lukisang **nasang**] [$_{\text{D}}$ lao di pallukis-na *pro*],
though 3ERG-show-APPL she painting every to P painter-3GEN its
'Though she showed [−FIN] every$_i$ painting to its$_{i,j}$ painter,'

In tandem with this fact, the GOAL loses the ability to bind into the EXT.

(51) *The DP-PP Ditransitive: GOAL < EXT*

Mau na-yolo-ang [$_{\text{S}}$ sola-na *pro*] [$_{\text{O}}$ seni] [$_{\text{D}}$ lao di pallukis **nasang**],
though 3ERG-show-APPL friend-3GEN her art to P painter every
'Though her$_{*i,j}$ friend showed [−FIN] art to every$_i$ painter','

Despite this fact, it is clear that the GOAL must originate above the INT within this PDC. This is a fact that can be read directly from the system of reconstruction, which has been described in Mandar by Brodkin 2025c. In the domain of variable binding, Mandar follows English in allowing A-movement to reconstruct. Just as the targets of raising can reconstruct beneath experiencers for variable binding in English, then, the arguments that raise to SPEC,*voice*P can reconstruct beneath the DPs they cross for variable binding in Mandar. In regular ditransitives, variables in the GOAL can thus be bound by a quantified EXT (52b).

(52) *Reconstruction for Variable Binding*

a. His$_i$ mother seems to every boy$_i$ [___ to be a genius]. Lebeaux 1991, 231

b. Mau na-yolo-ang [$_S$ pallukis **nasang**] [$_O$ seni] [$_D$ sola-na *pro*]],
though 3ERG-show-APPL painter every art friend-3GEN her
'Though every$_i$ painter showed [−FIN] her$_{i,j}$ friends art,'

When the ditransitive GOAL is nested in a regular PP, it can bind into the INT in the same way (53a). This pattern seems to run parallel to a fact of English: in the PDCs of that language, ditransitive GOALs embedded in PPs can bind reflexives in the higher INT (53b).

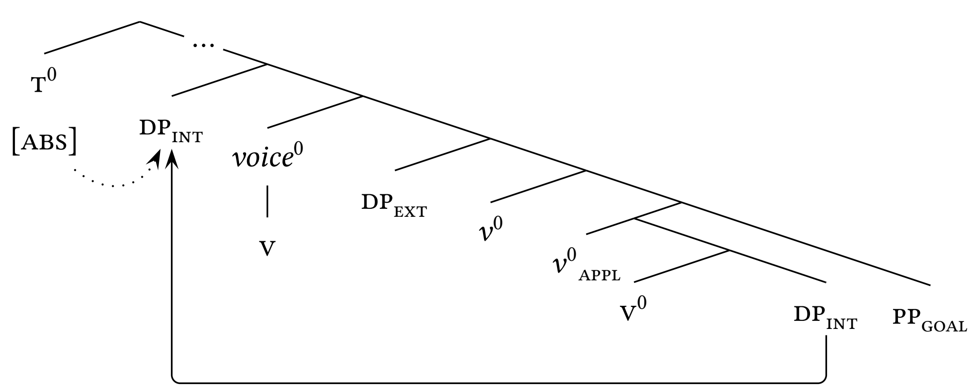
(53) *Prepositional Dative Construction: INTs Reconstruct Beneath GOALs*

a. Mau na-yolo-ang [$_S$ iKaco'] [$_O$ seni-na *pro*] [$_D$ lao di pallukis **nasang**],
though 3ERG-show-APPL NAME art-3GEN her to P painter every
'Though Kacho' showed [−FIN] her$_i$ art to every$_{i,j}$ painter,'

b. We gave [$_{INT}$ a portrait of herself$_i$] [$_{GOAL}$ to the dean]. McCloskey 2000, 44b

This fact suggests that this PDC starts from the same syntax as the DOC (following Chomsky 1975; Larson 1988, 2014; Ormazabal & Romero 2010, 2012, 2024; *cf.* Harley 2002; Bruening 2010a, 2018; Harley & Jung 2015; Harley & Miyagawa 2017): the GOAL originates above the INT in SPEC,*appl*P, but as it is nested in a PP, *voice*P is forced to skip it and attract the INT instead (54). The real import of this analysis, however, is the following: it suggests that it must be impossible to satisfy the EPP feature on *voice*^{0} by attracting a regular PP.

(54) *Prepositional Dative Construction: voice^0 Skips the PP GOAL*



3.3 Inversion and the Low Subject Position

This pair of results sets up a new type of analytical tension in the transitive *voice*PS in (55): when the INT is a regular PP, how does the syntax satisfy the EPP requirement of *voice*^{0}?

(55) *Riddles of the EPP*

a. Byasa i u-ola [$_{PP}$ **naung** **di** Majene].
usually 3ABS 1ERG-go downward P PLACE
'Usually I go down to Majene.'

b. Arere, mu-oro'-i bo-i [$_{PP}$ **diong di** engeang favorit-u]?
ugh 2ERG-sit-APPL again-3ABS down P spot favorite-1GEN
'Ugh, you're occupying down in my favorite spot again?'

At first blush, we might imagine that the low subject position simply attracts the EXT, but this view runs against the facts of agreement: T^0 strictly takes the third-person form *i*. The real problem for this view, however, emerges in the passive. Mandar has a $v^0{}_{\text{PASS}}$ *di-* that replaces the ergative prefixes and forces the suppression of the EXT (Brodkin 2022). When the verbs above are passivized with *di-*, the INT can still surface in a regular PP. In the ensuing clauses, it is clear that an ergative EXT cannot be raised to satisfy the EPP.

(56) *Riddles of the EPP: Round Two*

a. Byasa i di-ola [$_{PP}$ **naung** **di** Majene].
usually 3ABS PASS-go downward P PLACE
LLTERALLY: 'Usually it is gone down to Majene.'

b. Arere, di-oro'-i bo-i [$_{PP}$ **diong di** engeang favorit-u]?
ugh PASS-sit-APPL again-3ABS down P spot favorite-1GEN
LLTERALLY: 'Ugh, it's occupied down in my favorite spot again?'

To establish an analytical foothold, we can turn to the syntax of the predicates in (57): those that lack thematic arguments entirely. In the clauses built around these *voice*PS, T^0 takes the same third-person form (as across the subfamily: Jukes 2006; Kaufman 2008).

(57) *Riddles of the EPP: Round Three*

a. Urang i.
rain 3ABS
'It's raining.'

b. Minnassa i mua' anging i.
clear 3ABS that wind 3ABS
'It's clear that it's windy.'

In an unrelated investigation of raising, Brodkin 2025c argues that these clauses show the syntax in (58a): the EPP feature on *voice*^{0} forces the insertion of a null expletive *pro*. This analysis provides a explanation for the pattern of third-person absolutive agreement, which tracks the features of this element, and it can also give us a handle on the clauses that host absolutive PPS. When these elements appear as the INTS of transitive verbs, I propose that the language shows the the transitive expletive construction (Bobaljik & Jonas, 1996; Bobaljik & Thráinsson, 1998) in (58b); when they appear as the INTS of passives, we then have the impersonal passive (Perlmutter, 1978; Shibatani, 1985) in (58c).

(58) *Proposal: Low Subject Expletives*

a. WEATHER VERBS: [$_{TP}$ T^0 [$_{voiceP}$ *pro* *voice*^{0} [$_{vP}$ [$_{VP}$ V PP]]]]

b. TRANSITIVES: [$_{TP}$ T^0 [$_{voiceP}$ *pro* *voice*^{0} [$_{vP}$ DP$_{ERG}$ [$_{VP}$ V PP]]]]

c. PASSIVES: [$_{TP}$ T^0 [$_{voiceP}$ *pro* *voice*^{0} [$_{vP}$ [$_{VP}$ V PP]]]]

On this analysis, it is striking to note a second layer of symmetry between the clauses above: unlike the unaccusative and unergative verbs that introduce thematic arguments, weather verbs and their associates license the suppression of *di* in following locative PPS. As in the passive in (59a), the PP *dyaya di Ma'asar* "up in Makassar" can lose *di* and invert in the *voice*PS projected from verbs like *urang* 'rain' and *maroa* 'be crowded' (59b)-(59c).

(59) *Subjectless Verbs: License Inversion*

a. Di-oro'-i i [$_{pp}$ engeang favorit-u **diong** **Ø** __].
PASS-sit-APPL 3ABS spot favorite-1GEN down
'Down in my favorite spot is occupied.'

b. Urang i [$_{pp}$ Ma'asar **dyaya** **Ø** __].
rain 3ABS PLACE up
'Up in Makassar is raining.'

c. Maroa i [$_{pp}$ Ma'asar **dyaya** **Ø** __].
crowded 3ABS PLACE up
'Up in Makassar is crowded.'

These facts provide us with an initial clue that there is a link from the suppression of *di* to the low subject position: this process is possible whenever there are no other elements that must move to *voice*P. In the *voice*PS that project from unaccusatives and unergatives, this process is ruled out because the low subject position must attract their EXTS and INTS.

But in the transitive, passive, and nonthematic *voice*^{0}s above, there are no arguments that must be raised to SPEC,*voice*P—and in this context, it becomes possible for PPs to invert.

Against this backdrop, we can go on to observe the following fact: when *di* is lost, the complements of P^0 gain privilege in the system of variable binding. In the transitive *voice*Ps built around *engei* 'be in,' for instance, the INT cannot bind into the EXT from inside a regular PP (60a). But from inside a PP without *di*, it can bind into that DP (60b).

(60) *Inversion: Reshapes Variable Binding*

a. Mau na-engei [$_{\text{EXT}}$ mara'dia-na *pro*] [$_{PP}$ **dyaya di** istana nasang],
though 3ERG-be in king-3GEN its up in palace every
'Though its$_{*i,j}$ king occupied every$_i$ palace,'

b. Mau na-engei [$_{\text{EXT}}$ mara'dia-na *pro*] [$_{PP}$ istana nasang **dyaya**],
though 3ERG-be in architect-3GEN its palace every up
'Though its$_{i,j}$ king occupied every$_i$ palace,'

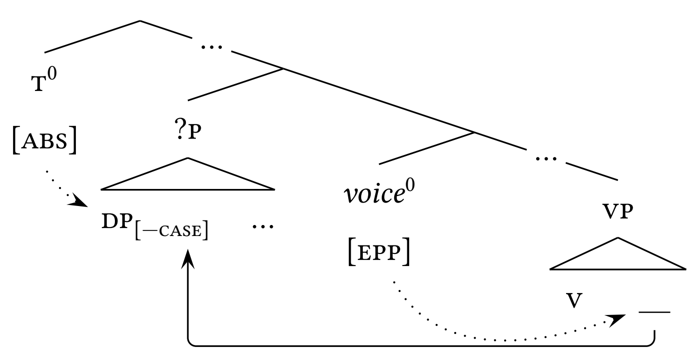
We can see the same effect in the PDC, where the GOAL cannot bind into the EXT from within a regular PP. If *di* is suppressed, the GOAL regains the ability to bind into that DP.

(61) *Inversion: Reshapes Variable Binding in the Ditransitive*

Mau na-yolo-ang [$_{\text{S}}$ sola-na *pro*] [$_{\text{O}}$ seni] [$_{\text{D}}$ pallukis nasang **lao**],
though 3ERG-show-APPL friend-3GEN her art painter every to
'Though her$_{i,j}$ friend showed [−FIN] art to every$_i$ painter','

These effects reveal that the loss of *di* requires intermediate movement to SPEC,*voice*P: in order for Caseless prepositional complements to interact with T^0, they must be carried up to the low subject position by a regular step of A-movement to the edge of the phase. The result is a decisive parallel to the analysis we proposed for the pseudopassive in (40b): when *di* is suppressed, we must have intermediate movement to the edge of the *voice*P.

(62) *Interaction with T^0: Intermediate Step to SPEC,voiceP*



3.4 The Targets of Movement

With this step of movement in place, we can now lay out the final mystery of the system. Despite the consistent basic word order of VSOD, there are a number of contexts in Mandar where movement to SPEC,*voice*P is overt. In the clauses that host auxiliaries, for instance, Brodkin 2025a shows that several types of prosodic manipulations can force this effect. The simplest is shown in (63): Mandar has a class of clause-final particles that carry heavy phrasal stress (63a), and when these surface immediately after the base position of the absolutive DP, a clash effect forces that DP to be pronounced in SPEC,*voice*P (63b).

(63) *Overt Movement to SPEC,voiceP*

a. Rua i [$_{voiceP}$ u-yolo-ang [$_{\text{INT}}$ formulir]] AE!
once 3ABS 1ERG-show-APPL form PRT
'I once showed her the forms, I'm telling you!'

b. Rua i [$_{voiceP}$ [$_{\text{GOAL}}$ iCicci'] u-yolo-ang __] AE!
once 3ABS NAME 3ERG-show-APPL PRT
'I once showed them to Chichi', I'm telling you!'

These patterns provide explicit linear evidence for our step of movement to SPEC,*voice*P: they position the absolutive DP below all auxiliaries and immediately above the verb (64).

(64) *The Covert Syntax of Subjecthood: Made Overt*

[$_{\text{TP}}$ T^0 [$_{voiceP}$ ~~DP~~$_{\text{INT}}$ *voice*^{0} [$_{vP}$ DP$_{\text{EXT}}$ [$_{\text{VP}}$ ~~DP~~$_{\text{INT}}$]]]]

When we suppress *di* in the contexts where movement is overt, however, we see the following result: what moves to SPEC,*voice*P is not the complement of P^0 but the entire PP.

(65) *Overt Movement to SPEC,voiceP*

a. Rua i [$_{voiceP}$ [$_{\text{GOAL}}$ **lao** iCicci'] u-yolo-ang __] AE!
once 3ABS to NAME 3ERG-show-APPL PRT
'I once showed them to Chichi', I'm telling you!'

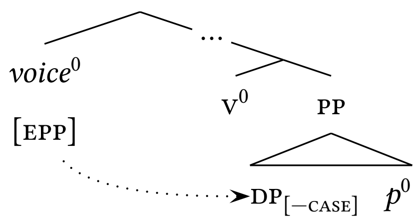
b. Rua i [$_{voiceP}$ [$_{\text{GOAL}}$ sola-u **lao**] u-yolo-ang __] AE!
once 3ABS friend-1GEN to 3ERG-show-APPL PRT
'I once showed them to my friends, I'm telling you!'

These facts suggest that the DP complements in this system are raised to SPEC,*voice*P by a process that raises the full PP. As this step feeds variable binding and agreement with T^0, however, it seems to be a regular type of A-movement that checks the *voice*P-level EPP.

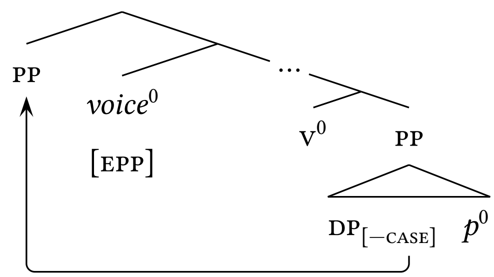
We are thus forced to understand how the A-syntax might drive attraction of a PP. Starting with the fact of visibility, we can return to the presence of Caseless DPs in SPEC,*p*P: unlike the regular PPs that host *di*, these PPs host elements at their edges that must be independently visible to the A-syntax, since they must ultimately receive Case from T^0. As a result, I propose that they must also be visible to the EPP probe on *voice*^{0} (66a). From this position, we can understand this step of movement as a regular case of PIED-PIPING (Ross, 1967; Bresnan, 1976; Webelhuth, 1992; Heck, 2009): a target for movement appears at the edge of some domain and the system of attraction draws up the containing XP (66b).

(66) *Pied-Piping in the A-Domain*

a. *Establishing Visbiility*



b. *Pied-Piping the PP*



The link to pied-piping yields a natural explanation for two key properties of this step: how the A-syntax triggers A-movement of PPs and why it only targets the PPs that lack *di*. But this pattern of pied-piping differs in two ways from its counterparts in the Ā-domain. First, it strictly targets the full PP, unlike the types of pied-piping that emerge under WH-movement and relativization and freely target constituents of varying size (67a)-(67b). In the same vein, it must be driven by the need to attract an element inside of the moved XP: the target of movement must be the Caseless DP in SPEC,*p*P, and its status as the target must flow from the rigidly-positioned feature [−CASE] on D^0. It diverges in this respect from the patterns of pied-piping linked to FOCUS, which is often taken to involve attraction of an operator whose DP-internal position is relatively free (Horvath, 2007; Hedding, 2022; Branan & Erlewine, 2023), and this asymmetry suggests that it cannot be reduced to a type of regular attraction that simply targets a containing QP (Cable, 2010), as in (67c).

(67) *Contrast: Pied-Piping in the Ā-Domain*

a. Reports [which] the government prescribes the height of the lettering on __

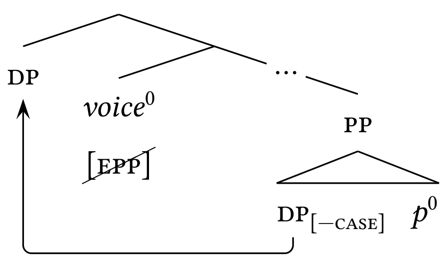
b. Reports [the height of the lettering on which] the government prescribes __

c. SEPARATE PHENOMENON: $[_{\text{FP}}$ QP F^0 … $[_{\text{QP}}$ Q^0 [WH]]].

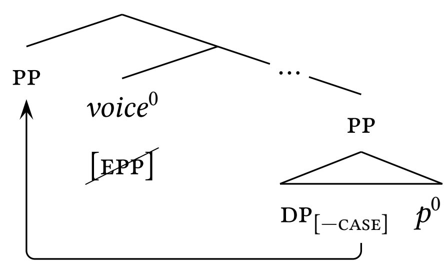
To make sense of these asymmetries, I propose that this step of movement is forced by the need to attract the Caseless DP and forced to target the PP by a constraint on locality. At the derivational moment where *voice*^{0} makes contact with the DP in SPEC,*p*P, more specifically, I assume that there are two paths to satisfy the EPP. Most obviously, that head could subextract the DP, yielding a step that must operate in pseudopassives which strand P^0 (68a). As an alternative, however, it must also be possible to satisfy the EPP by attracting the PP—given that its edge hosts an element of the category DP (68b).

(68) *Two Paths to Satisfy the EPP*

a. *Subextracting the DP*



b. *Pied-Piping the PP*



The path beyond this point must then be decided by two types of locality constraint. The first of these is the pressure for subextraction, which I take to have the shape in (69a): a constraint that demands attraction of the smallest possible target in order to minimize the structural distance between the movement-driving head and the matching element in its landing site (Heck, 2009). The second, I propose, is a locality constraint with the opposite shape: one that demands attraction of the closest possible target that will satisfy the features of the movement-driving head. Formally, we can understand this second pressure to follow from Chomsky 1995's definition of the Minimal Link Condition in (69b): one which allows us to treat the relevant pattern of subextraction as a violation of the A-OVER-A condition (Chomsky 1973; Bresnan 1976; Hornstein 2009; on the link between these constraints, see Fukui 1997, 1999; Müller 1998, 2011; Vicente 2007). Within the Mandar *voice*P, it is this second constraint that forces attraction of the PP.

(69) *Pied-Piping vs. Subextraction: Competing Constraints on Locality*

a. Local Agree — Heck 2009, p80

If a goal γ in Σ matches an active probe β, then no phrase boundary (XP) dominates γ but not β.

b. Minimal Link Condition — Chomsky 1995, 311

K attracts α only if there is no β, β closer to K than α, such that K attracts α.

4 Category Restrictions at the Edge

We thus arrive at a delicate configuration that yields A-movement and pied-piping of a PP: if the usual lines of licensing break down in the PP, the highest head in that domain triggers movement to the edge, and a movement-driving head on the clausal spine can deliver a path toward licensing by a higher head, then a specific ranking of locality constraints can drive A-pied-piping of the PP. Given the depth and specificity of these preconditions, it is thus no surprise that this possibility has flown beneath the radar up to this point. But as it turns out, there is a final layer to this system which suggests that the traditional view is largely correct: in the general case, A-movement does not pied-pipe (Safir, 2019) or target PPS (Polinsky, 2016). This is one which turns on a connection to height—and reveals, in turn, that the rules of A-attraction must be derailed at the edge of the phrase.

4.1 A Restriction on Raising

Our work begins in the arena of raising. Mandar has a class of raising verbs that includes *mala* "be possible," *minnassa* "be clear," and range of aspectual verbs. These verbs select clauses that lack absolutive agreement, and in the matrix clauses built around them, T^0 targets the embedded absolutive DP (which is usually pronounced in the lower *voice*P).

(70) *Raising Verbs in Mandar*

Minnassa **i** [$_{\text{TP}_{[-\text{FIN}]}}$ na-pomonge' iCicci'].
clear 3ABS 3ERG-love NAME
'It's clear that he loves Chichi'.'

With a little footwork, we can see that these verbs force their embedded absolutive DPS to raise to the matrix SPEC,*voice*P. In the presence of auxiliaries, we have seen, the right prosody will force the absolutive DP to be realized above the verb (71a). But without auxiliaries, this prosody forces a different effect: the verb precedes the shifted DP (71b).

(71) *Seeing the Path of Raising*

a. Minnassa i [$_{\text{TP}_{[-\text{FIN}]}}$ rua [$_{voice\text{P}}$ iCicci' na-pomonge' iKaco' __]] AE!
clear 3ABS once NAME 3ERG-love NAME PRT
'It's clear that Kacho' once loved Chichi', I'm telling you!'

b. Minnassa i [$_{\text{TP}_{[-\text{FIN}]}}$ na-pomonge [$_{voice\text{P}}$ iCicci' iKaco' __]] AE!
clear 3ABS 3ERG-love NAME NAME PRT
'It's clear that Kacho' loves Chichi', I'm telling you!'

Brodkin 2025a takes this pattern to suggest the further step of head-movement in (72): in clauses that lack auxiliaries, the verb raises out of the *voice*P. The result is that it must visibly precede SPEC,*voice*P in this context if we force high spell-out of the absolutive DP.

(72) *Verb Movement Beyond the Voice*P

a. [$_{\text{FP}}$ AUX … [$_{voice\text{P}}$ DP$_{\text{ABS}}$ V [$_{v\text{P}}$ DP$_{\text{ERG}}$ $\cancel{v}^0$ [$_{\text{VP}}$ $\cancel{\text{V}}^0$ ~~DP~~$_{\text{ABS}}$]]]]

b. [$_{\text{FP}}$ V … [$_{voice\text{P}}$ DP$_{\text{ABS}}$ ~~V~~ [$_{v\text{P}}$ DP$_{\text{ERG}}$ $\cancel{v}^0$ [$_{\text{VP}}$ $\cancel{\text{V}}^0$ ~~DP~~$_{\text{ABS}}$]]]]

This footwork gives us the tools to recreate a prosodic problem in the embedded *voice*P. When the base position of the absolutive DP would be adjacent to a clause-final particle, we have seen, the absolutive DP must be spelled out in SPEC,*voice*P (73a). But when the verb raises, we can create configurations where the particle will also be adjacent to SPEC,*voice*P (73b). When we do so beneath verbs of raising, we see the shift in (73c): rather than surface in the embedded SPEC,*voice*P, the absolutive DP is spelled out in the matrix SPEC,*voice*P.

(73) *Absolutive Movement Beyond the voice*P

a. [$_{\text{FP}}$ AUX … [$_{voice\text{P}}$ DP$_{\text{ABS}}$ V … ~~DP~~$_{\text{ABS}}$]] PRT

??

b. [$_{\text{FP}}$ V … [$_{voice\text{P}}$ DP$_{\text{ABS}}$ ~~V~~ … ~~DP~~$_{\text{ABS}}$]] PRT

c. Ndangi i [$_{voice\text{P}}$ iCicci' minnassa [$_{\text{TP}}$ na-pomonge' [$_{voice\text{P}}$ __ __]]] AE!
not 3ABS NAME clear 3ERG-love PRT
'It's not clear that he loves Chichi', I'm telling you!'

All of this is useful for what it reveals about pied-piping of the PP. When raising verbs select clauses that host embedded absolutive PPs, we can see that those PPs seem to interact with the matrix T^0 and raise to the embedded SPEC,*voice*P in the usual way (72a). It should thus come as a surprise that they cannot raise to the matrix SPEC,*voice*P (72b).

(74) *Raising: Trouble with Absolutive PPs*

a. Minnassa i [$_{\text{TP}}$ rua [$_{voice\text{P}}$ [$_{\text{PP}}$ **lao** iCicci'] na-be-ngang __$_{\text{PP}}$] AE!
clear 3ABS once to NAME 3ERG-give-APPL PRT
'It's clear that he once gave it to Chichi', I'm telling you!'

b. *Ndangi i [$_{voice\text{P}}$ [$_{\text{PP}}$ **lao** iCicci'] minnassa [$_{\text{TP}}$ na-be-ngang __]] AE!
not 3ABS to NAME clear 3ERG-give-APPL PRT
INTENDED: 'It's not clear that he gave it to Chichi', I'm telling you!'

This restriction suggests that something must go wrong in the space above the *voice*P: the absolutive PP cannot reach the launching site for attraction by the matrix *voice*^{0} (75a). It contrasts in this respect with the regular absolutive DP, which we might then suspect to be drawn to the edge of the embedded clause by a head in the extended TP (75b).

(75) *Raising Asymmetry: Trouble in the TP*

a. [$_{voiceP}$ __?? *voice*^{0} … [$_{TP}$ __ … [$_{voiceP}$ PP$_{ABS}$ …]]]]

b. [$_{voiceP}$ DP$_{ABS}$ *voice*^{0} … [$_{TP}$ ~~DP~~$_{ABS}$ T^0 … [$_{voiceP}$ DP$_{ABS}$ …]]]]

We can pin down the nature of this effect by leveraging another strategy to render the path of movement overt. Mandar has a large class of prenominal quantifiers that have an idiosyncratic effect on the system of spell-out: the phrases that they head must always be pronounced high (Brodkin, 2025c). When the absolutive DP hosts a quantifier of this type, then, it can never be spelled out in its base position: in the non-finite clauses introduced by *mau* "though," for instance, it must be pronounced in SPEC,*voice*P (76a). This requirement holds without regard to the facts of prosody, manifesting even in the absence of final particles, and it is unrelated to the facts of scope: quantified absolutives must be realized in this position even if they scope beneath other quantified DPs (76b).

(76) *Quantified Absolutives: Move Overtly*

a. Mau rua [$_{voiceP}$ [$_{INT}$ inggannanna paccoro] na-saka __],
though once all thief 3ERG-catch
'Though they once caught [−FIN] all the thieves,'

b. Mau ndang [$_{GOAL}$ ing. lessang] minnassa [$_{TP}$ na-be-ngang __ [$_{O}$ 3 loka] _],
though not all monkey clear 3ERG-give-APPL 3 banana
'Though it's not clear that they gave all the monkeys 3 bananas,' (✓3>ALL,✓ALL>3)

These QPs are useful because they reveal a step of A-movement into the middle field. The effect turns on a pair of aspectual enclitics, *mo* "already" and *pa* "yet," which surface in a head ASP^0 that sits just beneath T^0 (Brodkin, 2022). When we introduce these elements into the complements of *mau*, I claim that those clauses must project up to ASPP. In this context, we see the shift in (77): the absolutive QPs surface above the highest auxiliary.

(77) *Quantified Absolute Arguments: Move into the Middle Field*

Mau [$_{ASPP}$ [$_{INT}$ ing. sola-u] yari **mo** [$_{voiceP}$ ___ u-ita ___]],
though all friend-1GEN DID ALREADY 1ERG-see
'Though I already DID see [−FIN] all my friends,'

Brodkin 2025c shows that this second step of movement shows all the characteristic properties of A-attraction: it targets a single QP, strictly proceeds from SPEC,*voice*P, and (like regular movement to SPEC,*voice*P) does not interact at all with scope. In finite clauses, moreover, it occurs in the absence of *mo/pa* and positions these QPs to agree with T^0.

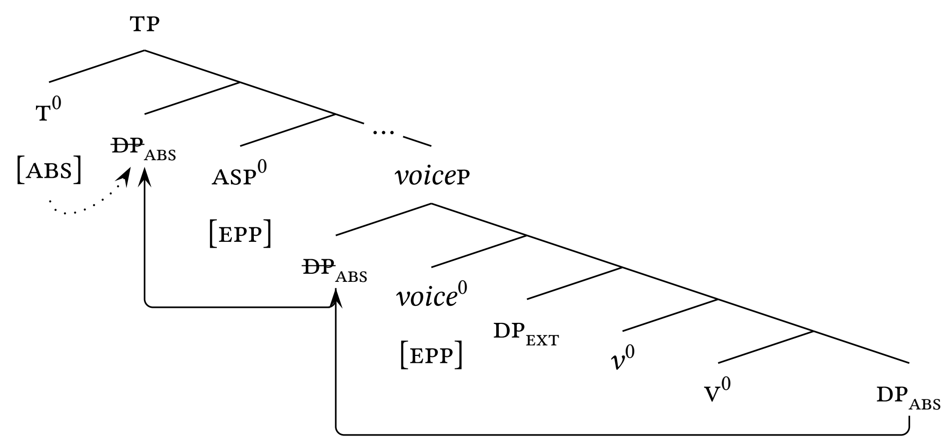
(78) *Middle-Field Movement: Feeds Agreement with* T^0

[$_{\text{TP}}$ [$_{\text{GOAL}}$ Ing. tau] rua **i** [$_{voiceP}$ __ u-carita-ngang [$_{\text{I}}$ ing. fakta] _]].
all person once 3ABS 1ERG-tell-APPL all fact

'I once told [+FIN] everyone all the facts.'

Building from these facts, Brodkin 2025c thus proposes the clausal syntax in (79): one on which there is second and higher subject position, falling just below the TP, that raises the absolutive DP from the low subject position and positions it to interact with T^0.

(79) *The High Subject Position*



We can now leverage the quantifiers to see what goes wrong in the system of raising. When absolutive QPs are nested in PPs, they raise in the regular way to SPEC,*voice*P in the non-finite clauses introduced by *mau* (80a). But when we introduce ASP^0, we encounter the restriction in (80b): unlike *voice*^{0}, the head ASP^0 is unable to attract an absolutive PP.

(80) *High Subject Position: Cannot Attract PPs*

a. Mau yari [$_{voiceP}$ [$_{\text{PP}}$ ing. sola-u **lao**] u-yolo-ang __],
though DID all friend-1GEN to 1ERG-show-APPL

'Though I once showed [−FIN] all my friends,'

b. *Mau [$_{\text{PP}}$ ing. sola-u **lao**] yari mo [$_{voiceP}$ __ u-yolo-ang _],
though all friend-1GEN to DID already 1ERG-show-APPL

INTENDED: 'Though I already DID show [−FIN] all my friends,'

4.2 Pied-Piping at the Edge

I take these results to suggest that there is a second layer to the A-syntax of pied-piping PPs: there is a categorial restriction on A-movement, obeyed in its usual way in the Mandar TP, that must be specifically relaxed around movement to the edge of the Mandar extended VP. This positional shift must have no external consequences on the ways that A-movement feeds the other systems of the syntax, as it triggers steps that feed binding and interaction with T^0, and as a result, it must emerge firmly within the A-domain (rather than implicating mixed A-Ā attraction of the type proposed by Webelhuth 1989 and Van Urk 2015). We thus come to the end of our investigation with two tasks in hand: to understand why this effect should emerge and how exactly it interacts with the regular ASP-level EPP.

To understand why the restrictions on category might loosen at the edge of the *voice*P, I propose to draw a connection to a second shift that seems to operate in the same position. This is one that emerges in the domain of relative locality, surrounding the generalization that A-movement must target the closest DP. The standard theory holds that ATTRACT must always target the highest licit goal (Chomsky, 1993; Richards, 1997): A-probes cannot skip intervening DPs (81a). But there is clear evidence for this type of attraction in the Mandar *voice*P: the A-probe on *voice*^{0} must skip the EXT to target the absolutive DP (81b).

(81) *Locality in A-Movement: The Puzzle*

a. Classical view: [$_{FP}$ _____ F$^0_{[EPP]}$ [$_{GP}$ DP$_{EXT}$ … [$_{HP}$ … DP$_{INT}$]]]

b. Mandar voiceP: [$_{voiceP}$ DP$_{GOAL}$ *voice*^{0} [$_{vP}$ DP$_{EXT}$ … [$_{applP}$ … DP$_{GOAL}$]]]

This analysis follows a long tradition that takes the High Absolutive Configuration to turn on the logic of ACTIVITY: the absolutive INT can raise because the ergative EXT is licensed in the extended VP and thus rendered invisible to the higher A-syntax of the TP. (Bittner & Hale, 1996b,a; McGinnis, 1998; Woolford, 2006; Legate, 2008; Ershova, 2019). But despite its utility, a decisive consensus has now coalesced against the general existence of Activity (Nevins, 2005; Chomsky, 2020): many languages feature subject positions that attract arguments with dative or oblique Case (Zaenen *et al.*, 1985; Belletti & Rizzi, 1988; Sigurðsson, 1989; Franks, 1995), many ergative languages show subject positions that attract ergative DPs which receive Case in the *voice*P (Davison, 2004; Anand & Nevins, 2006; Legate, 2006), and many languages show patterns of hyperraising that target subjects which bear nominative Case (Alexiadou & Anagnostopoulou, 1999; Ferreira, 2004, 2009; Nunes, 2008; Zyman, 2017, 2023; Deal, 2017; Halpert, 2019; Fong, 2019).

These facts suggest a second tension in the domain of locality: in the general case, A-movement cannot skip Case-licensed DPs, but at the edge of the Mandar *voice*P, it must. On the theory of CYCLIC SPELL-OUT, however, there is a natural way to explain this fact. Chomsky 2000 proposes that phase heads like *voice*^{0} must attract all the elements in their c-command domains that carry unchecked features before sending their complements to the interfaces. In the typical case, there are two types of elements that must be attracted in this way: regular DPs that receive Case in the middle field, like the nominative subject in (82a), and Ā-elements that raise into the CP-layer, like the WH-phrase in (82b). The ensuing steps of movement, however, are quite distinct, and as a result, I will assume that they are driven by separate types of features: [•D•] in the case of A-movement and [•X•], formally the EDGE FEATURES of (Chomsky, 2008), in the case of Ā-movement.

(82) *Attraction to the Edge*

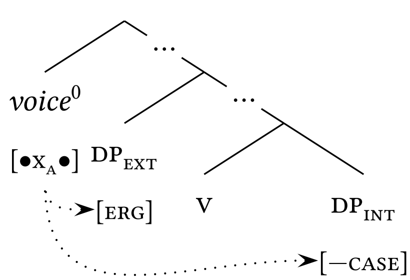
a. *A-Movement: [•D•]* $[_{voiceP}$ ___ *voice*$^0_{[\bullet D \bullet]}$ $[_{vP}$ DP$_{[-CASE]}$ $[_{VP}$ DP$_{[+CASE]}$]]]

b. *Ā-Movement: [•X•]* $[_{voiceP}$ ___ *voice*$^0_{[\bullet X \bullet]}$ … $[_{FP}$ DP … $[_{GP}$ WH …]]]

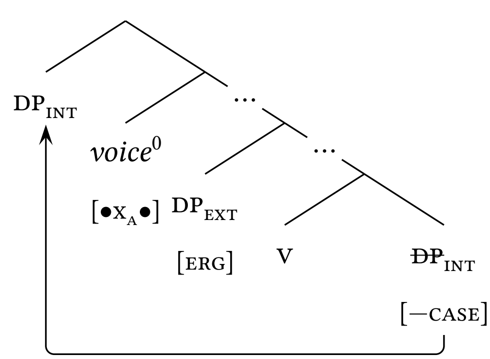
In a High Absolutive system, however, neither possibility will suffice: the absolutive DP must raise to the edge, but it cannot be drawn past the ergative EXT by strictly local A-movement or set up to receive Case from T^0 by Ā-attraction. As a result, I propose that the phase head must be endowed with a second type of edge feature in systems of this type: one that triggers non-local A attraction. I will denote this second type of feature [•X$_A$•]. At the derivational moment where it probes, it must skip past the Case-marked EXT in SPEC,*voice*P (83a) and preferentially attract the lower Caseless DP (83b)

(83) *Absolutive Arguments: Rescued by A-Edge Features*

a. *Non-Local Inspection*



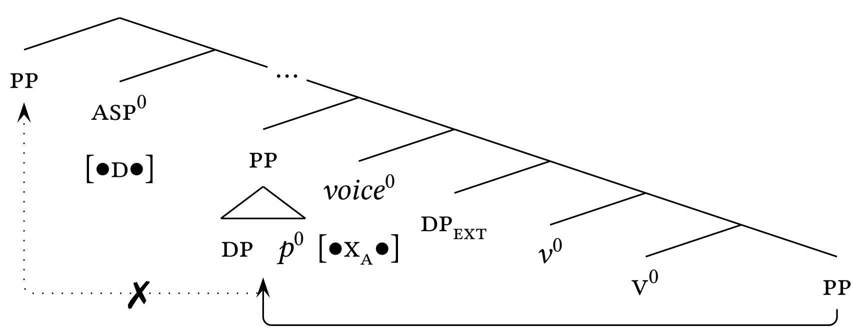
b. *Non-Local A-Movement*



We thus arrive at a system that allows a second type of A-movement at the phase edge: one driven by the familiar class of edge features that rescue formally needy elements from inside the phase and one that leverages them to resolve a Case-theoretic tension that arises in systems that require the heads of the middle field to license the absolutive DP.

In the arena of locality, this framework is useful for the fact that it allows us to capture a pattern that recurs across High Absolutive systems: absolutive DPs have been argued to raise above the ergative DP at exactly the edge of the clause-internal phase in many systems of this type (in Austronesian: Rackowski 2002; Aldridge 2004; Nomoto 2013, 2015; Erlewine 2018; Erlewine & Levin 2021; Nie 2020; Ting 2023; in Mayan: Coon *et al.* 2014; Royer 2023). But in the domain of pied-piping, it also has a secondary effect: it allows us to understand how the phase head might acquire the ability to trigger A-movement of a PP. Returning to the asymmetry between *voice*^{0} and ASP^0, more specifically, I propose that the distribution of pied-piping follows directly from the distribution of [•X$_A$•] and [•D•]. Pied-piping to SPEC,*voice*P, like all steps of attraction and expletive insertion that revolve around that position, must be driven by [•X$_A$•]. Movement to SPEC,ASPP, however, must be driven by the more restrictive feature [•D•]: one that forces strict locality and one that demands the attraction of a DP. This is the reason that only *voice*^{0} can attract a PP (84).

(84) *The Asymmetry in Category*

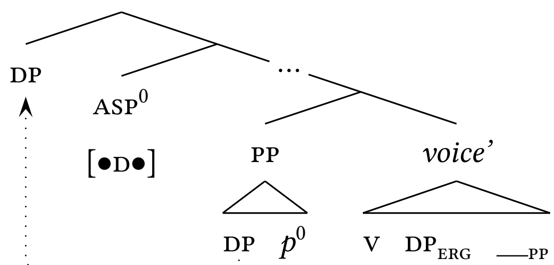


We thus arrive at a final layer of conditioning to this effect: under the exact conditions that allow the A-syntax to access the complements of P^0, we will only ever see pied-piping when the first point of contact with the clausal spine emerges at the very edge of the phase. In this context, the right ranking of locality constraints will force A-movement of a PP—and any alternative ranking, or any lower point of attraction, will force subextraction of a DP. It is one of these secondary differences that delivers the most salient difference between Mandar and English— in the latter language, the pseudopassive never pied-pipes the PP— and it is this final layer that typically masks the capacity of the A-syntax to attract PPs.

4.3 Preposition Stranding in Spec,VoiceP

We can now wrap up our investigation with a return to the facts of attraction to SPEC,ASPP. If everything we have said up to this point is correct, then we should expect ASP^0 to behave much like the heads of the English VP: given that it must bear the feature [•D•], it should encounter the Caseless DP at the edge of the extended PP and subextract it to SPEC,ASPP.

(85) *Prediction: Subextraction to SPEC,ASPP*



If this analysis is correct, it would place Mandar in the very narrow class of languages that allow A-movement out of the PP. Given the facts of raising, moreover, we are already positioned to argue for covert movement of this type: in the complements of raising verbs, we see *di*-suppression and inversion in the apparently low absolutive PPs (86a). As these patterns can only be licensed through interaction with the matrix T^0, it stands to reason that these DPs must be set up to raise into the matrix clause by the embedded ASP^0 (86b).

(86) *Raising: Covert Subextraction from the PP*

a. Minnassa i [$_{TP}$ rua [$_{voiceP}$ [$_{PP}$ **lao** iCicci'] na-be-ngang __$_{PP}$] AE!
clear 3ABS once to NAME 3ERG-give-APPL PRT
'It's clear that he once gave it to Chichi', I'm telling you!'

b. [$_{TP}$ T^0 [$_{ASP}$ __ ASP^0 [$_{voiceP}$ __ *voice*^{0} [$_{ASP}$ __ ASP^0 [$_{voiceP}$ [$_{PP}$ DP p^0] …]]]]

It is thus a satisfying fact that the prepositions in this system have the right phonology for this pattern of subextraction to be overt. In the default case, the directional and locative prepositions show the typical behavior of functional heads (Selkirk, 1995; Booij, 1996; Peperkamp, 1997; Hall, 1999; Itô & Mester, 2009): they are parsed as clitics, not prosodic words. This fact can be read from the language-internal diagnostics for the prosodic word and phonological phrase, two abstract phonological constituents on the universal prosodic hierarchy of Itô & Mester 2007, 2012. The PPs built around these heads show the prosody in (87): they contain a single stress in the complement noun, marking the word (ω), and a single high tone at the right edge of the full PP, marking the right edge of the phrase (ϕ).

(87) *The Canonical Parse of Prepositions*

$\{_\phi$ [$_\omega$ bémme$^{\text{H}}$] i } $\{_\phi$ **sung** di [$_\omega$ pepattóang$^{\text{H}}$] }
fall 3ABS out P window
'It fell out the window.'

When functional heads surface in this configuration, they are exempted from many types of prosodic requirement: they need not form ωs and do not even have to host feet. But functional projections like the PP are generally parsed into ϕs (Selkirk, 2009, 2011), and when their heads are stranded by subextraction or complement ellipsis, this mapping persists (Itô & Mester, 2019). As a result, stranded functional heads are always forced to form ϕs on their own, and many types of stranding are likely ruled out by the phonological requirements that emerge in that configuration. In the system at hand, however, there are no problems of this type. Mandar allows a type of complement ellipsis beneath the locative and directional prepositions, and when the p^0s stranded by this process are too small to form ϕs, the phrasal phonology actually sets up a range of repairs (Brodkin, 2025d): the directional P^0 *sung* "out," for instance, is augmented by a process of Vʔ-epenthesis (88).

(88) *Prepositions: Able to Form ϕs*

$\{_\phi$ [$_\omega$ bémme$^{\text{H}}$] i } $\{_\phi$ [$_\omega$ **sú'ung**$^{\text{H}}$] } ~~di pepattoang~~
fall 3ABS out P window
'It fell out.'

We should thus expect that raising to SPEC,ASPP will be able to overtly strand these p^0s, and this is exactly what we see. When we quantify absolutive PPs in finite clauses (89a) or force overt raising to subject with regular DPs (89b), we see P-stranding in SPEC,*voice*P.

(89) *Absolutive PPs: Stranding in SPEC,voiceP*

a. [$_{\text{DP}}$ Ing. sola-u] rua i [$_{voiceP}$ [$_{\text{PP}}$ __ **lao**] u-yolo-ang __].
all friend-1GEN once 3ABS to 1ERG-show-APPL
'I once showed it to all my friends.'

b. Ndang i [$_{\text{DP}}$ iCicci'] minnassa [$_{\text{TP}}$ na-be-ngang [$_{voiceP}$ [$_{\text{PP}}$ **lao** __] _]] AE!
not 3ABS NAME clear 3ERG-give-APPL to PRT
'It's not clear that he gave it to Chichi', I'm telling you!'

5 Conclusion

We thus conclude our investigation with a cascading series of discoveries on subextraction from the Mandar PP. At the highest level, we have seen that this language allows nominals to escape that domain by raising through the specifiers of higher heads in the extended PP: a pattern which reinforces the classical view that the extended PP must form a phase (Van Riemsdijk, 1978) and one that fits neatly, in turn, with the understanding that movement to its edge must obey a constraint on Comp-to-Spec Antilocality (Abels, 2003, 2012). In the link to the pseudopassive, moreover, we have found that Mandar allows A-movement to proceed along this path in response to a structural shift in the PP: one that suggests the same internal breakdown in licensing that seems to underlie the pseudopassive in English (Van Riemsdijk, 1990; Rooryck, 1996; Ramchand & Svenonius, 2004). In the surface system of spell-out, at last, we have seen that this process is able to visibly strand prepositions in light of a fact of phonology: extraction from the PP does not need to be covert because the phonology provides a path for prosodically minimal p^0s to form licit phonological phrases. The combined force of these results is to establish Mandar in the narrow class of languages that allow overt A-movement from PPs and clarify the conditions that allow this to occur.

Turning now to the higher shape of this system, our results point to a new perspective on the nature of A-attraction and its relationship to the category PP. To establish contact between the Caseless complement of P^0 and T^0, we have seen that the language requires an intermediate step of movement to a relatively high position in the extended VP, along the lines proposed for the English pseudopassive by Drummond & Kush 2015. In Mandar, this step must target the entire PP—but it feeds both variable binding and Case-licensing and only targets the PPs whose edges host Caseless DPs. These facts suggest that it is possible for the A-syntax to pied-pipe PPs: a conclusion which suggests that pied-piping must exist (*cf.* Cable 2010) and must occur equally within the A-syntax (*cf.* Safir 2019), albeit under the exacting positional constraint that A-pied-piping emerge only at the edge of the phase.

With this much in place, we can now weigh the wider consequences of this final claim: that there is, in effect, a second type of A-attraction that emerges at the edge of the phase. I have argued that the A-syntax gains the ability to pied-pipe PPs at the phase edge because of a wider positional release from the requirement that A-movement target the closest DP. This position fits neatly with the facts of A-attraction in Mandar, where the absolutive DP raises in a familiar way to that edge, but it may also give us a foothold on a separate pattern of A-attraction of PPs, and I will conclude by drawing a link to this final domain.

Davies & Dubinsky 2001 establish that the highest subject position in English—like its analogue in Mandar—cannot attract PPs (and see also Stowell 1981). When PPs seem to take the subject position in copular clauses, then, they are covertly encased in DPs (90a). The case for this view follows from a series of properties that fall to PPs in this position: for instance, they can license emphatic reflexives (90b), though regular PPs cannot (90c).

(90) *Puzzle Two: A-Positions Typically Inhospitable to PPs*

a. [$_{TP}$ [$_{DP}$ [$_{PP}$ Under the bed]] [$_{FP}$ is a good place to hide]].

b. [$_{DP}$ Under the bed and in the closet] are **themselves** good places to hide.

c. Leslie hid [$_{PP}$ under the bed and in the closet (***themselves**)].

Despite this fact, there is a context where the syntax of subjecthood seems to draw up an unambiguous PP, and this is one that emerges in the context of LOCATIVE INVERSION. In clauses like (91a), the initial PP fails every test that would suggest encapsulation in a DP: it cannot license emphatic reflexives (91b), float quantifiers, or control PRO (Postal, 2004).

(91) *Locative Inversion: Movement of PPs*

a. [$_{PP}$ Under that sofa] may have been lying two snakes.

b. *[$_{DP}$ Under that sofa] may **itself** have been lying two snakes.

Even so, there is very good evidence to suggest that these PPs are raised at some point by a step of A-movement that places them above the subject (the DP that agrees with T^0). Culicover & Levine 2001 observe that locative inversion has the same effect on variable binding as regular A-movement: like raising across experiencer PPs (92a) and unlike topicalization (92b), it allows quantified targets to bind variables in elements they cross (92c).

(92) *Locative Inversion: Binding Evidence for A-Movement*

a. [$_{FP}$ Every$_i$ kid $F^0_{\cancel{[EPP]}}$ [$_{GP}$ seems [$_{PP}$ to his$_i$ mother] [$_{TP}$ __ to be a genius]]].

b. [$_{TOPP}$ [$_{PP}$ Into every$_i$ dog's cage] $TOP^0_{\cancel{[EPP]}}$ [$_{TP}$ its$_{*i}$ owner [$_{voiceP}$ peered __]]].

c. [$_{FP}$ [$_{PP}$ Into every$_i$ dog's cage] $F^0_{\cancel{[EPP]}}$ [$_{vP}$ peered its$_i$ owner __]].

Postal 2004 and Bruening 2010b reject the A-movement analysis and propose instead that locative inversion involves high base-generation of these PPs in a topic position, with the syntax of subjecthood carrying up a null expletive of the type that seems to be absent from every other corner of the language. But we can immediately dispatch with this view on the grounds of reconstruction: Bresnan 1977 observes that the PPs in this construction can undergo raising, as in (93a), and just like the usual targets of that operation, we can observe that they can reconstruct beneath experiencers for variable binding (93b).

(93) *Locative Inversion: Raising Evidence for A-Movement*

a. [$_{CP}$ Under the bed seemed [$_{TP}$ to live a monster of unimaginable strength __]].

b. [$_{CP}$ Under his$_i$ bed seemed to every$_i$ kid [$_{TP}$ to live a monster of unimaginable strength __]].

The result is that the PPs in this construction must be raised above the subject by a process that feeds variable binding and further steps of A-movement: one that seems a relatively exact analogue to the special type of A-movement that I have proposed to emerge at the edge of the phase. For this reason, I propose that locative inversion does not involve a direct step of movement to SPEC,TP (*cf.* Collins 1996): rather, the PPs in this construction are first attracted by this second type of A-movement to SPEC,*voice*P. Given that they fail the tests for encasement in DPs, I propose that they fail to undergo any higher step of A-movement to SPEC,TP. Building on the tight link from locative inversion to topicalization (Bresnan 1994; Rizzi & Shlonsky 2006; Den Dikken 2006), I assume that they reach their high position via direct Ā-movement to a specifier in the extended CP. Setting aside the exact positions of the subject and verb, we thus have the syntax in (94).

(94) *Locative Inversion: Special A-Movement to SPEC,voiceP*

[$_{CP}$ [$_{PP}$ Under the bed] lived [$_{voiceP}$ __ a monster of unimaginable strength __]].

From here, we can understand locative inversion to show the same middle-field syntax as another construction that forces A-movement of an Ā-element to the edge of the *voice*P: subject WH-questions like (95), where the WH-phrase must skip the regular subject position (McCloskey, 2000; Agbayani, 2000; Holmberg & Hróarsdóttir, 2003; Fitzpatrick, 2006; den Dikken & Griffiths, 2018; Messick, 2020; Bošković, 2024). Whatever lies beneath this effect, it may license skipping in the context of locative inversion as well— and once it is properly understood, it may deliver a path to understand the step of raising in (93).

(95) *Parallel: Subject WH-movement*

[$_{CP}$ [$_{DP}$ Who] [$_{TP}$ ___ [$_{FP}$ left [$_{voiceP}$ __ [$_{vP}$ __ ...]]?

Naturally, exciting mysteries remain. But on balance, it would seem, there is progress to be made by admitting the possibility for A-movement of the category PP.

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